

Music

Hymns & Spirituals
Folk Songs
Afternoon Listening
Composer Study
Sol-fa





About the Course

This course includes the following topic(s): Composer Study, Hymns & Spirituals, Folk Songs, Sol-fa: Level 4, Afternoon Listening

About Hymns & Spirituals

Students sing hymns and spirituals to build their faith and appreciation of God's work across time. Hymns and spirituals are connected to the historical time period as appropriate.

About Folk Songs

Students sing folk songs connected to the time period (1800-1900).

About Composer Study

In this course students are immersed into the 19th century via it's composers, instruments, and musical performances. Term 1 focuses on several influential instruments/instrument families, including valved brass, the saxophone, and the guitar, and the musicians that made them famous. In Term 2, students will grow to know and love the Norwegian Romantic composer, Edvard Grieg. Students conclude the year in Term 3 with the comic operas of Gilbert & Sullivan and their choice between two composers who turned what they saw or heard into music: Modest Mussorgsky and Thomas ("Blind Tom") Wiggins.

About Sol-fa: Level 4

Learn to sight-sing in new keys, time signatures, and rhythms. Continue studying the basics of music theory. Train ears with melodic and rhythmic ear tests, learn how to compose music, and gain further freedom and facility in sight-singing. Audio lessons are included in the lesson plans.

Skills Focus: Time signatures, note values, scales, and dictation.

Hymns & Spirituals

The Christian hymn and spiritual tradition is incredibly rich, and it is vanishing from many churches. In addition to bringing a much-needed moment of peace to your day, hymns can also introduce students to important theological ideas and church liturgy.

Folk Songs

The purpose of learning folk songs is twofold: to increase students' enjoyment of music and to situate folk music in its historical context in an effort to give students a richer understanding of the times and places that birthed the songs. A musical score is sometimes included for songs, but does not always exactly match the audio used, since folk songs are primarily oral songs and often take many different forms. Studying folk music helps students grow deep roots in our shared heritage and gives insight into historical events from the perspective of the people who were there.

Composer Study

"Music is no isolated thing. Its forms, colors, and expressive qualities do not spring from nowhere; they come out of life itself. Often, of course, they are to be enjoyed for themselves alone, in the concert hall or in one's armchair. But music also reflects human experiences, hopes, and struggles. It may give an insight into the individual and society, into the lives of those far removed from our own in time and place—an insight no other art can provide in this exact way."
~Elie Siegmeister



Placement & Combining Tips

All music lessons except sol-fa are shared between Grades 2-12, making them ideal lessons for multi-age groups.

Composer Study

These Composer Study lessons are shared across grades 2-12 with extensions provided for

older students. Students in Grades 2-3 with no classical music background may choose to take Intro to Music Appreciation first, but the composers in this rotation are particularly accessible for a wide range of ages.

Sol-fa: Level 4

Prerequisite: Sight-Singing with Sol-fa Level 3 or appropriate skill proficiency. Students in Grades 4+ with no experience with sol-fa or sight-reading music should start with Level 2.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
1-12	Hymns & Spirituals 1 time/week 10 min	Our Hymns, Our Heritage
1-12	Folk Songs 1 time/week 10 min	Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song
1-12	Afternoon Listening 1+ time/week 10 min	
2-12	Composer Study 1 time/week 10 min 1 time/week 15 min	Playlist for the Year Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition Song in a Rainstorm: The Story of Musical Prodigy Thomas Blind Tom Wiggins
5+	Sol-fa: Level 4 1 time/week 15 min	Fifty Steps in Sight-Singing Sol-fa Level 4 Audio Lessons
	Shared course resources	Our Work: Grades 4-6 Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Level 4				
Sol-fa: Level 4 Afternoon Listening		Hymns & Spirituals	Folk Songs	Composer Study



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

Hymns & Spirituals

☐ Bookmark the Alveary hymns, spirituals, and folk song playlist for the year, or create your own YouTube, Spotify, or Amazon playlist if desired.

Composer Study

- Charlotte Mason often included more music in the program than could be covered in the lesson time. While we choose segments that fit the length of the lesson, students will develop a relationship with the term's music insofar as it is a part of their daily atmosphere.
- The YouTube playlist contains nearly the whole year's music, though lessons will occasionally have extra links to historical or musical information. This playlist is mostly used in the lessons as videos are often chosen for visual and sometimes historical interest. You will also find a spotify playlist of the term's music in Quick Links for easy afternoon listening.
- Use the year's playlist to listen to previous and current pieces in the afternoons, and explore the Extra Helpings as interested (ideas which relate directly to a lesson are usually included nearby, while more general resources and activities are listed on the Extra Helpings page). Grade 5+ extensions are also usually appropriate as Extra Helpings for interested younger students.

Sol-fa: Level 4

☐ Bookmark Sol-fa playlists (see Quick Links). If you create a free account on the SoundCloud app, the Sol-Fa lessons become downloadable for offline use.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

Music: Level 4



Our Work: Grades 4-6



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF

Hymns & Spirituals



Our Hymns, Our Heritage

Folk Songs



Like a Bird: The Art of the American Slave Song

Composer Study



Playlist for the Year



Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition



Song in a Rainstorm: The Story of Musical Prodigy Thomas Blind Tom Wiggins

Sol-fa: Level 4



Fifty Steps in Sight-Singing



Sol-fa Level 4 Audio Lessons



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

∞ [View Supply List Details](#)

Sol-fa: Level 4



Piano or Keyboard



Quick Links

Music: Level 4

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

Click THIS text
or scan the QR
code for links.



Hymns & Spirituals

- ∞ [Hymns, Spirituals & Folk Songs Spotify Playlist](#)
- ∞ [Hymns, Spirituals & Folk Songs Youtube Playlist](#)
- ∞ [Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF](#)
- ∞ [Musical Terms Appendix](#)

Folk Songs

- ∞ [Hymns, Folk Songs, & Spirituals Youtube Playlist](#)
- ∞ [Hymns, Folk Songs, & Spirituals Spotify Playlist](#)
- ∞ [Musical Terms Appendix](#)

Composer Study

- ∞ [Extra Resource: Classics for Kids Musical Dictionary](#)
- ∞ [Composer Study Playlist \(YouTube\)](#)
- ∞ [Composer Study Playlist \(Spotify\)](#)
- ∞ [Appendix: Musical Vocabulary](#)
- ∞ [Century Chart](#)
- ∞ [Foundations \(See Section 12: Music\)](#)

Sol-fa: Level 4

- ∞ [Warm-Ups \(Audio\)](#)
- ∞ [Warm-Ups \(Video\)](#)
- ∞ [Blank Staff Paper](#)

Music: Level 4

How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the

melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 1 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 1

Step 15a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ INTRO

Warm up your voice for a couple of minutes.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15a

∞ Video Link: Amazing Grace

∞ Video Link: Waltz

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WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 1

How Firm a Foundation

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage, Our Work Book, and/or Music Selections Booklet

→ INTRO

Our first hymn this year is called "How Firm a Foundation." What is a foundation, and what do you think this hymn will be about?

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Today, focus on getting familiar with the hymn. Read the words aloud and listen to the full song. Note that various recordings sometimes use the older "thee" rather than "you" and annotate your lyrics depending on the recording you use. Notice, talk about, and look up any unfamiliar words.

∞ Music Links: How Firm a Foundation (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from Our Hymns, Our Heritage.

"Text and Tune" p.136

• EXTRA HELPING

Look at early copies of Rippon's hymnal. What differences and similarities do you notice between it and hymnals today? If interested, read the original hymn (note the extra verses which are less common today) and the prefaces.

∞ Book Links: 1801 and 1828 versions

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Use your preferred recording to listen to the hymn in the afternoons, evenings, or anytime! The more you spend time with it, the more the words will sink into your head and your heart.

• IMPORTANT DATES

"How Firm a Foundation" published in Rippon's hymnal (1787 AD).

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 1

Steal Away

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Like a Bird

→ INTRO

• The word "steal" usually means to take something that isn't yours. Can you think of any other meanings the word has?

• Tell what you think this sentence means: "Let's steal away now and tell them what we saw!"

→ READ & DISCUSS

Our first folk song for the year is called "Steal Away to Jesus." Its history is somewhat debated. Some think that Nat Turner was one of the first to sing it. Others tell the story of Wallace Willis and how the Reverend Alexander Reid heard Willis singing "Steal Away" (and Swing Low, Sweet Chariot) and told the Jubilee Singers, a famous singing group, about his songs in 1871. It's often hard to trace the history of songs that were orally composed and passed along to others!

★ TEACHER NOTE

Feel free to choose your own version of Steal Away to learn. Just know that the lyrics vary widely, so another audio or video is unlikely to match the words in your Our Work or Music books.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to the term's songs throughout the week!

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

Like a Bird p.29

∞ Article Link: History Article 1 or History Article 2

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Refer to your Our Work/Music PDF lyrics as you listen.

∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

WEEK 1 15m Composer Study - Lesson 1

Music in the 19th Century

→ INTRO

• What (if anything) comes to mind when you think about the 1800s and particularly music in the 1800s? Jot down any notes in your notebook or share with a friend.

• In term 1, we'll explore some instruments that characterized this century and then get to know a few particular composers and musicians in later terms.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

One instrument that spans all cultures and times is the human voice, but each time and place features it in different ways. Opera became particularly popular in the 1800s, and some became huge productions that showcased the flexibility, beauty, and power of the voice in various ways. Today's piece is an aria from an opera called "La Donna del Lago" or "The Lady of the Lake" by Gioachino Rossini, which was based on a poem by Sir Walter Scott. Even though the words are in Italian, see if you can guess the emotion of the piece as you listen in this lesson and over the week on your own time.

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Tanti Affetti

Time Marker: 0:0-5:06 or whole piece if time allows

- What kind of feeling do you think this piece communicates? Why?
- How does this piece show off the beauty, power, or flexibility of the human voice?

→ (GRADE 5+) READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: 19th Century Classical Music

★ TEACHER TIP

Musical terms are defined throughout the lessons, but an appendix with all the terms and definitions for the year is also provided in Quick Links for your convenience. Reference as desired.

Instruments are ideal for Book of Century, History Chart, or music notebook sketches. Encourage students to add to their notebooks as desired. Dates for key people and events are also provided throughout the plans.

∞ PDF Link: Century Chart

• IMPORTANT DATES

La Donna del Lago first performed (Italy, 1819AD)

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: How Vocal Chords Work

WEEK 2 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 2

Step 15b

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15b

∞ Audio Link: Step 15b Answer Key

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Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 2

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book, Bible

→ RECAP

What is the name of the hymn for this term, and what is it about? Tell anything else you remember about its history.

→ SING

Practice the tune by first listening to a verse, then humming the next two.
∞ Music Links: How Firm a Foundation Full Song (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Let's focus on the lyrics a bit more. Read the whole song aloud, then look up the Bible verses below (mentioned last week in your hymnal) and tell what you notice about the images, ideas, or even direct words that the hymn writer used from each verse.

- Isaiah 41:10 (Stanza 2)
- Isaiah 43:2 (Stanza 3 & 4)
- Zechariah 13:9 (Stanza 4)
- John 10:27-29, Romans 8:38-39, Hebrews 13:5-6 (Stanza 5)

→ (OPTIONAL) COPYWORK (GRADES 4+)

Write one of the Bible verses above underneath your hymn lyrics or in your copywork book.

★ TEACHER TIP

If teaching in a classroom setting, assign verses to various students to keep this part of the lesson from taking too long.

● EXTRA HELPING

More on the song's history and how the author used bible verses in his composition. Note the additional verse

∞ Video Link: Hymn Story, Analysis, Performance

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 2

Steal Away (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, United States Atlas or a Globe

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of "Steal Away"?

→ SING

Listen to the full song, paying attention to the lyrics. Then listen again and hum along.

∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ OR VIEW

Steal Away became an enormously popular song across the United States and the world because of the Fisk Jubilee Singers. Fisk University was founded in 1866, right after the Civil War ended with the Emancipation Proclamation. Students who had previously had limited access to higher education because of slavery and poverty flocked to its doors. But a few years later, the school was struggling financially, and many feared it would have to close. However, relief came from an unexpected source—one of the school's leaders organized a group of the school's talented singers and set up a series of concerts. Initially, they sang classical and popular songs familiar to their white audiences, but eventually the students began also singing the spirituals that they had sung during the years they were enslaved. These spirituals, like Steal Away and Swing Low, Sweet Chariot, skyrocketed the Fisk Jubilee Singers and the school to fame, and both still exist today! Read or watch more about the Jubilee Singers and listen to a recording of Swing Low, Sweet Chariot from 1909 with the remaining time!

∞ Article Link: Jubilee Singers Article

or

● EXTRA HELPING

View the Extra Helpings page for books, documentaries, and resources on the Jubilee Singers!



Term 1

∞ Video Link: Jubilee Singers Video

→ LISTEN (OPTIONAL)

∞ Audio Link: Swing Low, Sweet Chariot

WEEK 2 15m Composer Study - Lesson 2

Different Types of Vocal Poetry

PREP: Notebooking sound can be a little tricky. Listen to John Muir Laws talk about capturing birdsong in his notebook to give students ideas on how to sketch some of what they hear in today's musical piece(s) and others throughout the year.

∞ Video Link: Birdsong in your nature journal

→ RECAP

Describe the piece we started listening to last lesson.

→ INTRO

Musical performances in the 19th century became both larger and smaller. Operas and other theatrical performances became more accessible to the middle class and not just the wealthy, but so did the private musical performances in homes or smaller venues. Arias like Tanti Affetti showcased the voice on the large stages, while intimate songs, setting a poem to music with just a piano and voice, explored the power of the human voice to express emotion in these smaller settings. In Germany, several composers wrote so many of this second type of song that they created their own genre of song (called "lieder") and became the standard that others followed.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Notice any musical features common in bel canto operas, such as trills, melismas, coloratura passages, and even appoggiaturas as you listen to the vocal fireworks that end this aria. You may want to pause the video periodically to jot down what you notice/hear in your notebook. Don't feel like you need to capture the whole aria - just a few key moments that strike you as great!

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Tanti Affetti

Time Marker: 5:06-end

- What did you notice?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Über allen Gipfeln ist Ruh

Time Marker: 0:00-1:52

- (Grades 5+) Discuss or sketch the differences in mood, sound quality, and anything else you notice about these two pieces.

• TERMINOLOGY

Bel canto opera: literally "beautiful singing" and a style of opera featuring the voice, which focuses on conveying the emotion of a piece through the singing rather than simply moving the plot forward.

Coloratura: literally "colorful" singing with fast-moving passages, trills, and vocal leaps.

Trills: moving between two notes very fast.

Melisma: multiple notes sung on one syllable.

Advanced Listening:

Appoggiatura, Chromatic scales

∞ Video Link: What is appoggiatura?

Lieder: German art songs usually featuring piano and voice, where the pianist and singer are equal partners working to interpret and showcase the emotion of the poetry.

WEEK 3 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 3

Step 15c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE



Term 1

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15c

∞ Audio Link: Step 15c Answer Key

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WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 3

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing the tune of How Firm a Foundation on "hoo" and read the words aloud. Pay attention to the meaning and punctuation as you read.

→ SING & DISCUSS

Today, listen to a line of the song, then pause the video and echo it back, working your way line by line through the song. This will help you focus on each line of the song, not just the ones that come easily to you.

∞ Music Links: How Firm a Foundation Full Song (YouTube or Spotify)

- What images or lines in the song do you like best?

→ COPYWORK (GRADE 4+)

Copy a line of the melody into your music journal and (if you are taking sol-fa), see if you can label the notes with the sol-fa syllables. Hint: it is written in the key of G, and the first note is "So." Count up how many different sol-fa syllables you used in the song [there should be five]. This hymn is written using the pentatonic scale (often a major scale omitting fa and ti). Many other hymns (like Amazing Grace) are also written with only these five different sol-fa syllables. Explore Extra Helpings to explore a music theory rabbit hole on pentatonic music.

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 3

Steal Away (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, World Map/Globe/Google Maps

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "Steal Away"?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the full song. Then listen again and try to sing along with the recording when the singers repeat the first four lines.

∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

→ MAPWORK

The initial group of Jubilee singers disbanded in 1878 after six strenuous years touring across North America and Europe, but a new group came together and began touring again in 1894, singing everywhere from Canada to Kolkata (then Calcutta), from New England to New Zealand.

View the article and map to get a general sense of the choir's tour and look up as many of the places mentioned as time allows. Note that some cities have been renamed.

∞ Article Link: Jubilee Singer Travels (start reading at the paragraph under the map which describes the tour)



Term 1

WEEK 3 15m Composer Study - Lesson 3

Vocal Poetry cont.

→ RECAP

Recall any new musical terms you learned last lesson.

→ READ & NARRATE

Let's learn a bit more about the person who composed the song we started learning last lesson.

∞ Article Link: All About Fanny Mendelssohn

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

"Goethe's Wanders Nachtlied II (Über allen Gipfeln) is considered by many to be the most perfect lyric in the German language. The poet is supposed to have written the poem on the evening of 6 September 1780 onto the wall of a lodge on top of the Kickelhahn Mountain near Ilmenau, where he supposedly spent the night" (Interlude article)

English Translation:

"Over all summits
Is peace,
In all treetops
You feel
Hardly a breath:
The birds are silent in the woods.
Only wait, soon
You too shall rest"

Think of these lyrics as you listen again to Fanny's lied (pronounced "leed").

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Über allen Gipfeln ist Ruh

∞ Reference Link: About Goethe's poem (explore the other lieder based on this poem as desired).

- How do you hear the music trying to paint a sound picture of the poetry? Think about the dynamics (loud/soft, smooth/rough), melody, and rhythm.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

- Across the world from Germany, musicians were setting poetry to song in India as well. These songs were called "kritis" and are renowned for the same things as lieder: the balance of melody, rhythm, and poetry in their use of the human voice as an instrument.
- Begin listening to this famous kritis from the early 19th century, saving a minute or two for discussion.
- Optional: As you listen, sketch a veena in your music notebook. In the same way the piano accompanies the voice in German lieder, the veena is the main instrument accompanying the voice in Carnatic music.

∞ Image Link: Veena

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Soundararajam by Dikshitar

- What similarities and differences do you hear in the way the voice is featured?

★ TEACHER NOTE

If your students are having a hard time connecting with Über allen Gipfeln, feel free to spend the whole lessons with Soundararajam, the second piece.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Assigned selections fit in the lesson, but students will develop a relationship with the term's music insofar as it is a part of their daily atmosphere. Use the year's playlist YouTube and/or Spotify playlists to listen to previous and current pieces in the afternoons.

• EXTRA HELPING

Explore more lieder and more about Carnatic music and Muttuswami Dikshitar in extra helpings.

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 4 ☐ 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 4

Step 15d

☐ Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15d

∞ Audio Link: Step 15d Answer Key

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WEEK 4 ☐ 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 4

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

☐ Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

✕ GATHER SUPPLIES: Paints or sketching materials

→ RECAP

Recite the hymn (as much as able).

→ SING

Try to sing the whole song with the accompaniment. Note the areas where you aren't as sure of the tune or the words.

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE

With remaining time (and feel free to continue on your own time if desired), sketch or paint an illustration for each verse in your music notebook or alongside your lyrics.

★ TEACHER TIP

If a student has a hard time coming up with an idea for an illustration, encourage them to focus on just one image from a verse to illustrate. There are no wrong illustrations as long as the student connects it to an aspect of the verse in their mind. The purpose is simply to help them inhabit and reflect on the verse in a different way.

WEEK 4 ☐ 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 4

Steal Away (cont.)

☐ Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of "Steal Away" as you can from memory. Note the spots where you get stuck!

→ INTRO

If you could ask some of the first Jubilee Singers any questions, what would you ask?

→ SING & PRACTICE

∞ Music Links: Steal Away (YouTube or Spotify)

→ LISTEN

Steal Away is a popular choice for many different artists and groups. Listen to a few different renditions of the song (scroll down the playlist to see a few more options).

∞ Music Links: Steal Away Versions



Term 1

WEEK 4 □ 15m Composer Study - Lesson 4

□ Materials: Globe/Atlas

Parents and Cousins of the Guitar

→ MAPWORK

Locate the following places in your atlas and (for older students) consider making a page of your music notebook a map and labeling the instruments for each location.

- Scotland (where Sir Walter Scott lived, who wrote the poem which inspired Rossini's opera)
- Naples, Italy (where Tanti Affetti was first performed)
- Germany (where Fanny Mendelssohn Hensel and other composers who made the lied famous lived)
- Southern India (homeplace of Muthuswami Dikshitar, who wrote the kritis from the last lesson)

→ INTRO

Today, information can travel the world in milliseconds because of the internet. In the 19th century, people and ideas traveled more slowly but inventions such as instruments did travel and change through both time and place to give us new types of sounds and instruments. For instance, the violin traveled from Europe to India and took on new sounds as it was worked into the compositions of composers such as Dikshitar and others. Another instrument that rose to new prominence in a variety of places was the guitar (and its cousins).

Many trace the origins of the guitar back to the oud from North Africa and Persia. It traveled to Europe in medieval times and gave birth to the lute. A version of the lute called the vihuela de mano traveled to South America with the Spanish and, in the early 1800s, the charango was created. Another version of the lute or oud seems to have influenced the West African folk lute called the akonting, which traveled with enslaved Africans to the Caribbean and Americas and became the banjo in the 1830s. Meanwhile, back in Europe, the lute had given birth to the baroque guitar, which kept undergoing slight changes throughout the 19th and 20th centuries until we arrive at the modern guitar.

Start exploring the sounds of some of these instruments today with the rest of the lesson time.

→ READ/LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Charango

∞ Video Link: Charango de los Andes

∞ Video Link: Guitars 200 years ago

Time Marker: 0:0-2:30

∞ Video Link: Cripple Creek (Banjo tune)

→ (GRADES 1-4) DRAW

Sketch a charango, a banjo, or a guitar in your music notebook.

→ (GRADES 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Minstrel Banjo

• MUSICAL CONNECTION

If you did Alveary Composer lessons in Rotation 1, you'll remember learning about the oud and European lutes!

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 5 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 5

Step 15e

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15e

∞ Audio Link: Step 15e Answer Key

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WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 5

How Firm a Foundation (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Music PDF or Our Work Book

→ RECAP

Sing hymn from memory (as able).

→ SING

Now that you know the words better, experiment with how you sing the song. Pick a few ideas to try or come up with your own. Think about how to emphasize the meaning of the words by the way you sing different verses. Are there other instruments you would use? Use the recording as needed.

- Sing some verses faster or slower.
- Sing some parts soft and some loud.
- Sing the song as a 2-part canon. To do this, divide into two groups (if with at least two people) or use the recording as your second person if solo. Group 1 should start singing, and then Group 2 begins at the beginning when Group 1 hits the "tion" in "foundation" in the first line (see #57 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage to see where Group 2 comes in). Because of the way the song is composed, the two groups will sound nice together even while singing different words!

∞ Audio Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

• EXTRA HELPING

Experiment with more than two groups singing this hymn in a canon or round, and try starting at different places to see what sounds best. For instance, Group 2 could wait to start until Group 1 begins the second line of music in your hymnal. Or you could try having four different groups!

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 5

Wellerman

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, World Atlas/Globe/Google Maps

PREP: For younger students, mark sections of the article on our next folk song's history to read or share with your students. Print off sheet music if desired.

∞ Article Link: Wellerman History

∞ PDF Link: Wellerman Sheet Music

→ RECAP

Sing Steal Away from memory.

• TERMINOLOGY

Wellerman: ship owned by the Weller brothers coming with supplies

tonguing: refers to the process of cutting up the whale for oil

right whale: a species of whale that is now endangered because of the whaling industry that was so prevalent in the 19th century.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Weller brothers found their



Term 1

→ INTRO

- Do you know any sea shanties? Our next folk song is a sea shanty that tells a story about a whale. While the story is made up, the Weller brothers were real men who founded a whaling base in 1831 on Aotearoa/New Zealand's South Island. A version of the shanty likely became popular a few decades later, before another author/editor developed the lyrics into their current form in the 1960s.
- Locate New Zealand in your atlas or globe and see if you can find Otakou (look on the South Island).

→ LISTEN & READ

Follow along with the lyrics as you listen to the song.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

→ READ

With remaining time, start reading (older students) or sharing (younger students) about the history behind the Wellerman. See Extra Helpings for more on whales, whaling, and the Wellermans.

∞ Article Link: Wellerman History

whaling base on the Otago peninsula in New Zealand (1831 AD)

WEEK 5 15m Composer Study - Lesson 5

Pedro Ximénez Abril Tirado

Materials: Globe/Atlas

PREP: Print off a blank world map to label if desired.

∞ Map Link: Blank World Map

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the guitar's ancestors and cousins? Add the locations (or add arrows showing the way instruments traveled) to your map in your notebook if desired.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Today's guitar piece is by a significant Peruvian composer named Pedro Ximénez Abril Tirado, who spent a lot of time in Bolivia. He was influenced by European music as well as local traditions, and some of his most famous works are for the guitar. Perhaps local musicians also played his works on the popular charangos as well!

∞ Video Link: Minuet #95

- Describe this piece in five words or less.
- How does it sound similar or different from the voice pieces we've heard so far this term?

→ (GRADE 5+) READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Tirado bio

• MAP WORK

Europe: guitar (from Persian oud -> lute)

Caribbean/North America:

banjo (from oud (?)) -> West African akonting)

Bolivia: Charango (from oud (?)) -> Spanish lute)

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Minuets #2 & #15

• IMPORTANT DATES

Pedro Ximénez Abril Tirado (Perú & Bolivia, 1784-1856AD)

WEEK 6 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 6

Step 15f

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE



Term 1

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15f

∞ Audio Link: Step 15f Answer Key
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WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 6

Children of the Heavenly Father

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage

(Optional) PREP: Read p.170 in your hymnal and the longer article about Lina and mark additional sections to share.

∞ Article Link: More about Lina

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice by singing "How Firm a Foundation."

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

You might not have heard of our second hymn this term, but it is a beautiful reminder of God's love for his children. Read from the hymnal and share any additional sections from the article as desired (older students can read the article directly).

Our Hymns, Our Heritage, "Text and Tune" p.170

→ LISTEN, PRACTICE, & DISCUSS

Bookmark #74 in Our Hymns, Our Heritage, and read the English words aloud. Then listen to the full song.

∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

- What did you think of the song after hearing a bit about Lina's life?
- Discuss any unfamiliar words.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Carolina Sandell Berg (Sweden, 1823-1903 AD)

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to the song in the original Swedish (and feel free to learn the song in Swedish instead of English if you'd rather!).

∞ YouTube Links: Tryggare kan ingen vara

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 6

Wellerman (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP

- Review Steal Away.
- What do you remember about our new folk song?

→ LISTEN

Listen to the song once or twice. Pay attention to the verses, as there are some words that go by quickly! As you begin to catch onto the tune, start singing the chorus with the recording.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

→ EXPLORE

With remaining time, finish reading (older students) or sharing (younger students) about the history behind the Wellerman, or see Extra Helpings for more on whales, whaling, and the Wellermans.

∞ Article Link: Wellerman History

WEEK 6 15m Composer Study - Lesson 6

Father of Classical Guitar

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

Add Pedro Ximénez Abril Tirado to Peru on your map.

→ INTRO

Just a few years before Pedro Abril Tirado died, a baby was born in Spain

• IMPORTANT DATES

Francisco Tárrega (Spain, 1852-1909 AD)

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Explore a few other pieces by Tárrega in the YouTube playlist in the afternoons. Plus, enjoy a violin rendition of Recuerdos de



Term 1

who would bring the guitar even further into the musical spotlight. Francisco Tárrega studied both the piano and the guitar growing up, and then studied music theory and composition. He is called the father of classical guitar because he showed how the guitar could be a solo instrument like the piano, voice, or violin, and create expressive melodies. (Before Tárrega, some thought the guitar was only good for folk songs and accompanying singers.)

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Today's piece is possibly Tárrega's most famous work. Pay attention to how fast the guitarist's fingers are moving to create the tremolo you hear!
∞ Video Link: Recuerdos de la Alhambra

- Which guitar piece has been your favorite over the last few lessons?

→ (GRADE 5+) READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: Tárrega bio

Alhambra!

• TERMINOLOGY

Tremelo: quickly plucking the strings on the guitar to create the sense of a continuous shimmering sound.

WEEK 7 ☐ 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 7

Step 15g

☐ Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 15g

∞ Audio Link: Step 15g Answer Key

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WEEK 7 ☐ 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 7

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

☐ Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or World Atlas

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

- What is "Children of the Heavenly Father" about?
- Locate Sweden on your atlas or globe. Can you find Småland or Stockholm?

→ READ & SING

- Read the lyrics aloud.
- Write down the beginning of each verse to help you remember the order.
- Work on the tune by alternating between listening and humming with the verses. Slow down and pause the tune after each line and hum the melody back if you run into any tricky spots.
- ∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

Can you think of any Bible stories or verses that Lina might have thought of when she wrote this song? [One option to read and discuss: Isaiah 40:11 and see the Extra Helping link for additional reflections on each verse]

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Reflections on CoftHF



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WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 7

Wellerman (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, sketching supplies (optional)

→ RECAP

Can you hum (or sing?) the Wellerman's chorus?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the song once through and mark any sections that you know you don't know well. Then listen again and pause the video after each line of the verses to echo it back.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

→ ILLUSTRATE (OPTIONAL)

With any remaining time or in the afternoon, sketch an illustration to go with this song. (One idea: look up pictures of a right whale and draw a diagram.)

WEEK 7 15m Composer Study - Lesson 7

Valved Brass

→ RECAP

- Who was Francisco Tárrega?
- Add his name to your map near Spain.
- Can you hum a tune from his Recuerdos de la Alhambra?

→ INTRO

Our next instrument is the horn! Horns have been around for a very long time, but it's only since the 19th century that they could easily play a lot of different notes. Horns make sound based on the length of space the air has to vibrate in their brass tubes. As long as the tube length stays the same, there is a limited number of notes a musician can play because of the way sound waves work. But if you change the length of the space the air has to vibrate in the tubes, you can play more notes. Before the 19th century, musicians would change the length of tubing by adding additional sections or inserting their hand into their horn. This was not very convenient for musicians, so when the idea occurred to instrument makers to add valves that opened and closed extra sections of tubing, it revolutionized horn music.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

At the beginning of the term, we talked about how the 19th century is famous for music, both on a large scale and in smaller settings. Horns are instruments that composers love to use when they want to create a big sound! John Phillip Sousa was an American composer who was nicknamed the march king. Listen for all the horns in the march we're listening to today!

∞ Video Link: The Stars & Stripes Forever

- Did you hear the horns?

→ DRAW

Sketch a valved brass trumpet in your music journal and/or Book of Centuries.

∞ Image Link: Valved horn

→ (GRADE 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

You will not be able to finish the video during the lesson, so just listen with the remaining time, and you will finish it next week.

∞ Video Link: Harmonics Explained

★ TEACHER TIP

Encourage students to listen actively to the music. For some, this may mean moving while they listen. Others might want to continue notebooking what they hear while they listen. Encourage students to try different ideas.

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: Understanding Period Instruments

• IMPORTANT DATES

John Phillip Sousa (US, 1854-1932)

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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WEEK 8 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 8

Step 16a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 16a

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WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 8

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you recite or sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics?

→ SING

Practice singing "Children of the Heavenly Father" today. If you can hum the whole tune from memory, sing the words along with the recording. If you are still working on the melody, pause the video after each line and sing it back. This will help you learn the song in its entirety.

∞ Music Links: Children of the Heavenly Father (YouTube or Spotify)

→ WRITE OR ILLUSTRATE

• Describe or start to sketch an illustration for each verse of the song, OR (Grades 6+) pick a verse from the song and rewrite it in your own words.

• COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)

Paraphrase the rest of the song in prose (or feel free to write a poetic paraphrase!).

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 8

Wellerman (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite as many of the words (or sing as much of the song) as you can from memory.

→ SING

Continue working on the words and tune! Focus on parts you don't know by pausing the video after a line to echo the song back.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Listen to another sea shanty (see options in Extra Helpings). How does it feel different or similar? What do you think makes a good "work" song?

WEEK 8 15m Composer Study - Lesson 8

Stars and Stripes Forever

→ RECAP

What is a "valved brass" instrument, and how is it different from the brass

• EXTRA HELPING

Funny article and bio of Sousa as well as along bio with extra details on the structure and history of the Stars & Stripes forever.



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instruments that people used before it?

→ INTRO

A lot of wars and revolutions occurred in the 1800s, which made marches exceptionally popular.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

March while you listen to the music.

∞ Video Link: The Stars & Stripes Forever

- What makes this music so good for marching?
- Name as many instruments as you can that you see in the video.

→ (GRADE 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Finish the video on harmonics that you began last lesson.

∞ Video Link: Harmonics Explained

∞ **Article Link:** Marching with John

∞ **Article Link:** Stars & Stripes Extended History

WEEK 9 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 9

Step 16b

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 16b

∞ Audio Link: Step 16b Answer Key

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WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 9

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe or US Atlas

→ RECAP

Recite "Children of the Heavenly Father" (as able), and mark any spots that need work.

→ SING

Warm up your voice by humming a favorite song, then sing "Children of the Heavenly Father" with the accompaniment (without looking at the words if you can!). Don't worry if you make a mistake; just keep going and then go back afterward to check the words and sing the song again.

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

→ READ & DISCUSS

Tell what you know about events happening around the world in the 1800s from anything you've learned in other subjects.

One of the reasons this hymn became so popular not only in Swedish but in English was due to two things: the famous soprano Jenny Lind who toured in North America and sang some of Lina's songs and the number of



Term 1

Swedes who immigrated to North America. We'll learn more about Jenny Lind next lesson.
 ∞ Article Link: Swedish Immigration

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 9

Wellerman (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of the Wellerman as you can from memory.

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen to the full song once, paying attention to any difficult spots. Then try to sing the song yourself with the karaoke version.

Consider creating your own accompaniment to the song by tapping a rhythm, marching as you sing, etc.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify

∞ Video: Wellerman Tune

→ READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: Work Songs

WEEK 9 15m Composer Study - Lesson 9

Saxophone

→ RECAP

Describe the Stars and Stripes Forever. Add John Phillip Sousa to your map (the US).

→ INTRO

You may remember hearing about the saxophone if you've used the Alveary lessons on Jazz, but the instrument was invented in the early 1800s and used in classical repertoire before it took off into the world of jazz and blues. Adolphe Sax patented the instrument and displayed it at the 1844 Paris Exhibition, and his instruments won a competition with other manufacturers and were adopted by the French military band! Adolphe's friend Jean Baptiste Singelee composed some of the first pieces of published music for the new instrument.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

The recording below lets you see the instrument live, but the following recording in the playlist uses an actual saxophone created by Adolphe Sax! So be sure to listen to that one over the week as well!

∞ Video Link: Septième Solo de Concert

• Describe the sound of the saxophone. What other instruments does it remind you of?

→ VIEW & DISCUSS (GRADES 1-4)

History & Making of the Saxophone

Time Marker 0:0-2:00

→ (GRADE 5+) VIEW & DISCUSS

Use the remaining time to learn more about Sax and the saxophone.

∞ Video Link: Murder & Saxophones

• IMPORTANT DATES

Adolphe Sax (Belgium/France, 1814-1894 AD)



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WEEK 10 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 10

Step 16c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 16c

∞ Audio Link: Step 16c Answer Key

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WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 10

Children of the Heavenly Father (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you still sing "How Firm a Foundation" from the first part of the term?

→ SING & DISCUSS

- Sing the song without the accompaniment. Then check yourself with the tune and lyrics.

- Sing the song again and experiment. Although many recordings play the melody quite slowly, aspects of the tune feel more like a lullaby or dance. Try singing it like a lullaby, and play with the dynamics (speed, volume, etc.). What type of singing best fits each verse?

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

→ (OPTIONAL) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Jenny Lind was a sensational singer and devout Christian from Sweden (and recently fictionalized in *The Greatest Showman*). She popularized Carolina Berg's melodies in her concerts. With the remaining time, learn more about Jenny's tour via video or article.

∞ Article Link: About Jenny Lind (Article)

∞ Video Link: About Jenny Lind (Video)

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to a beautiful choir arrangement of Children of the Heavenly Father!

∞ Audio Link: Dan Forrest Arrangement

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 10

Wellerman (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP & INTRO

- What did you learn about 19th-century work songs in the last lesson? Do you think we have work songs today?

- Fun fact: in the United States, work songs (like *Steal Away* and other spirituals) became the roots of what would become jazz and the blues in the 20th century.

→ SING

Can you sing *Wellerman* from memory now? Listen to the song first before trying, if needed. Feel free to sing with your own accompaniment.

∞ Video Link: Wellerman YouTube

∞ Audio Link: Wellerman Spotify



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∞ Video: Wellerman Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Enjoy a different take on Wellerman! Discuss how/if the different musical styles and/or instruments change the feel of the song.

∞ Video Link: Ragtime Wellerman

∞ Video Link: Symphony Wellerman

WEEK 10 15m Composer Study - Lesson 10

Saxophone

→ RECAP

What new instrument did we start learning about last lesson? Add the saxophone/Adolphe Sax to your map in Belgium (where Sax was from) or France (where he mostly lived and worked).

→ DRAW, LISTEN & DISCUSS

The saxophone is considered a woodwind instrument even though it has some similarities with brass horns. Sketch a picture of a saxophone in your notebook as you listen.

∞ Image Link: Picture of a saxophone

∞ Video Link: Septieme Solo de Concert (same as you heard last lesson)

OR

∞ Video Link: Fantaisie for Saxophone (if you want to hear a new saxophone piece)

• Do you think the saxophone fits best in an intimate, smaller setting (like the voice & piano lieder we heard) or a large musical setting (like the horns)?

→ (GRADE 5+) DISCUSS

Adolphe Sax created a new instrument by looking at other instruments like the clarinet and ophicleide (kind of like a tuba) and then creating an instrument with elements of both. Think about instruments you know and imagine what a new instrument you could create. What two instruments would you try to combine? Sketch out possibilities for your new instrument!

WEEK 11 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 11

Step 16d

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 16d

∞ Audio Link: Step 16d Answer Key

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Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 1

WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 11

Term Recap

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Try to recite both hymns from the term.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment).

∞ Video Link: How Firm a Foundation Tune

∞ Video Link: Children of the Heavenly Father Tune

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 11

Term Recap

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ DISCUSS

Which folk song from the term was your favorite? Why?

→ SING

Try to sing both songs from the term acapella (just your voice and your own accompaniment).

WEEK 11 15m Composer Study - Lesson 11

The Paris World Fair

PREP: If teaching younger students, read today's article and mark sections to share with students. Older students will enjoy reading the article directly and can explore extra links and videos on the page on their own time or over exam week.

→ RECAP

Name as many pieces and/or instruments as you can that we've listened to this term.

→ INTRO

As you've heard over the term, many "new" instruments in the 19th century were not actually new. But they came into the public eye in fresh ways, whether because they were optimized (the horns), reimagined (saxophones), repositioned (guitars), used in fresh ways (the voice), or introduced in new contexts. The 1889 World's Fair in Paris, celebrating 100 years since the French Revolution, featured an example of this last category when Claude Debussy and several other French composers heard Javanese gamelan orchestras play for the first time. Javanese Gamelan orchestras and their instruments are not at all new, but it was one of the first times the Western world was exposed to their sounds.

→ READ, LISTEN & DISCUSS

Learn about gamelan orchestras and some of the key instruments, and then begin listening to the piece at the end of the page.

∞ Article & Video Link: Gong-chime orchestra

- Sketch one of the instruments in the article as you listen.
- How would you describe the sound of the orchestra to a friend?

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: Photos of the World's Fair

Term 1	
WEEK 12 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 4 Coursework	
WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 12 Exam Week → ANSWER QUESTION(S) RELATED TO COURSE. Questions will come from: Hymns & Spirituals	
WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 12 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Folk Songs	
WEEK 12 15m Composer Study - Lesson 12 Exams → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Composer Study	

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 1 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 13

Step 17a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. Remember to pause the video as needed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 17a

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WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 13

Angels We Have Heard On High

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ INTRO

What do you know about the scene where the angels came to the shepherds to tell them about Jesus? If you haven't read it before, look up Luke 2:6-20. Our first song this term depicts this meeting!

→ READ, DISCUSS, & LISTEN

Read the lyrics aloud and discuss any unfamiliar words; then listen to the whole song.

∞ Music Links: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & NARRATE

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text and Tune" p.30

• IMPORTANT DATES

Angels We Have Heard on High published (1855 AD in French; 1862 AD in English)

• EXTRA HELPING

The history of this hymn is more complex than the hymnal's condensed version. With various translations and up to twelve original stanzas, the carol's many evolutions show how popular it became in both French and English!

∞ **Article Link:** History of Translation

∞ **Article Link:** French Lyrics (includes a more direct English translation).

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 13

National Anthem

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

PREP: You'll be choosing a national anthem to learn this term. Feel free to pre-select or use this lesson to decide. Consider having students learn their own national anthem (if young and/or unfamiliar with it) or another (pick based on interest and/or degree of challenge, since some are obviously not in English).

→ INTRO

The 19th century was a period of turmoil. The last part of the 18th century and the first half of the 19th is sometimes called the "Age of Revolutions." There was the American Revolution (1776), the French Revolution (1789), Haitian Revolution (1791) and then the Mexican War of Independence (1810s), uprisings across Latin American (one of the most famous was in Colombia with Simon Bolivar in 1810s), waves of revolutions across continental Europe (including Greece gaining independence from the Ottoman Empire in 1820s), revolts against British rule in India in the 1850s and against the shogunate in Japan in the 1860s (and that isn't all of them!).

★ TEACHER NOTE

Students will learn their own (or a different) national anthem this term. This brings many opportunities to talk about healthy (and unhealthy) ways to relate to one's country.



Term 2

Amidst all this upheaval, a new genre of folk song rose up—the national anthem. These folk songs gave a sense of shared identity and purpose among disparate peoples. Some sound like hymns, others like military marches, work songs, or even operas. You'll learn one anthem this term, but we'll listen to several different ones so you can hear these differences and similarities!

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

- Scroll down the playlist to see multiple options or look up a different one if desired.
 - Once you've decided which anthem to learn, listen to the whole thing.
 - Read the words aloud and/or copy them into your Our Work Book or another notebook if needed.
- ∞ Music Links: National Anthems (YouTube Playlist or Spotify Playlist)

WEEK 1 15m Composer Study - Lesson 13

Meet Edvard Grieg

📄 Materials: Globe/World atlas

→ INTRO & MAPWORK

- Our composer this term is a famous Norwegian composer named Edvard Grieg. One fun fact about him is that he was only 5' tall! Spend a few minutes getting to know a bit more about him.
- ∞ Audio Link: About Grieg

- Locate Norway, Germany, and Denmark in your atlas/globe. Can you find the Norwegian cities of Bergen (where Grieg was born) and Oslo? Copenhagen, Denmark? Leipzig, Germany (where Grieg studied)?

→ (GRADE 5+) VIEW & DISCUSS

Scan the list of Grieg's compositions. What stands out to you? Any wonderings? Any guesses on how his music might compare to other composers you've met?

∞ Article Link: List of Compositions

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Our first piece by Grieg is his piano concerto in A minor, which was one of his earliest compositions and his last. First published in 1868 when he was only 24 years old, he continued to revise the work up until the end of his life. The last version, which he finished only weeks before his death, is the one most performed today. The first movement is too long for the lesson, so just start listening to the piece with the remaining lesson time and continue listening to the rest of the concerto in the afternoon. The very first notes of the piece are some of the most famous.

∞ Video Link: Concerto in A minor

★ STUDENT (G9+)/TEACHER RESOURCE

∞ **Podcast Link:** More about Edvard Grieg

• IMPORTANT DATES

Edvard Grieg (1843-1907AD, Norway)

Piano Concerto in A minor written (1868AD)

• TERMINOLOGY

Concerto: A large musical composition (usually comprised of three movements) featuring a solo instrument accompanied by orchestra; often features one or more cadenzas.

WEEK 2 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 14

Step 17b

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. Treat the ear tests like puzzles. Sing the notes in between to figure out the tricky

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

intervals.

∞ Audio Link: Step 17b
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WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 14

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What is "Angels We Have Heard On High" about?

→ STUDY & SING

Today, we're focusing on learning the tune and words separately.

- Even if you can't read music, look at the music in your hymnal and notice that the shape of the top notes in the first line is the same as the second line. So once you learn the tune of the first line of music, you've learned the tune for the rest of the verse!
- Now find the first "Deo" you see in the sheet music. Even though it looks like a lot of notes, you'll see in your Our Work book or Music PDF and notice in the music that for the chorus you sing "Gloria in excelsis Deo" twice. And the only note that is different the second time is the very last note of the song.
- Now listen to the song and pay attention to those repeated lines (feel free to highlight them with different colors or make a note in your lyrics if desired)! Hum along with the recording as you pick up the tune.

∞ Music Links: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the words of the song aloud either in your hymnal, Our Work, or Music pdf.

• MUSICAL NOTE

When you sing "Gloria" in the chorus, you are singing a melisma – many notes on one syllable. While this is common for songs featuring just one artist, it is uncommon for congregational songs. Can you think of any other melismas in songs you've sung? Melismas are sometimes called "runs" or "riffs" in pop music.

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 14

National Anthem (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the rise of national anthems?

→ SING & PRACTICE

- Listen to your National Anthem of choice to work on the tune. Hum any refrains or repeated parts you start to recognize.
- Read or listen to the words aloud.
- Finish copying the words (if applicable) into your notebook.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

National Anthems can also be found in the Spotify Playlist in Quick Links.

→ READ & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: About National Anthems

★ TEACHER NOTE

Look up sheet music for your anthem of choice if desired to use as an aid in learning the tune, especially if it is one of the more complicated ones! Googling "[Name of anthem] sheet music PDF" is usually successful. Similarly, an audio recording of the lyrics can be helpful when learning an unfamiliar language.

WEEK 2 15m Composer Study - Lesson 14

Concerto in A Minor

→ RECAP

Tell what you remember about Edvard Grieg.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Read/share from the note in the YouTube description to learn more about our concerto. For older students, consider looking at the score as you

• EXTRA HELPING

Advanced challenge: Diagram Grieg's concerto by looking at the score (see link in extra helpings) and listening to the music. Start with the three movements and then use the dynamic markings and the "A" or "B" markings in the score to help you see how Grieg divides each movement.



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listen. Notice that the second movement is marked as "Adagio," which means "at ease" and generally tells musicians to play at a slow, relaxed pace. Pay attention to other terms you see on the score and reference your vocabulary appendix, or guess at the meaning based on what you hear.

∞ Video Link (YouTube): Concerto in A minor

Time Marker: 12:51 - 20:15

- How does this second movement sound different from the first or third?

- Grieg's concerto is often compared to Robert Schumann's concerto, which premiered only a few years earlier. Both composers completed only one concerto, both in the key of A minor, and both are now very famous. Listen to just the first few seconds of Schumann's concerto and then the opening of Grieg's concerto and discuss any similarities you hear and explore further on your own time.

∞ Video Link: Schumann Concerto

- Fun fact: Grieg's third movement begins with a tune that was likely influenced by a Norwegian folk dance called Halling. Learn more about Halling in extra helpings if interested!

→ (GRADE 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Franz Liszt was one of the 19th century's most famous pianists. Hear the story of his meeting with Grieg and his reaction to the concerto.

∞ Video Link: When Liszt Played Grieg

Time Marker: 5:34-end

WEEK 3 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 15

Review Sharps, Flats, & Moveable Do

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

∞ Video Link: L2 Lesson 3.9

After listening to the lesson, narrate it orally or in writing. Why do we need sharps and flats? What is the difference between a scale in the key of C and a scale in the key of G?

WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 15

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the chorus of "Angels We Have Heard on High"?

→ SING

We're putting the tune and text together today, so listen to a line of the hymn, then pause and sing it back. If you feel confident in the words, you can sing along; echoing helps us pay attention to each line.

∞ Music Links: Angels We Have Heard (YouTube or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

• COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)

Write your own retelling of the angels' and shepherds' meeting. You can write it as a poem or carol like "Angels We Have Heard on High," a play, a picture book, or a short story.

Extra challenge: Use a commentary or other study helps from Bible lessons to read more about shepherds in NT times and other aspects of Luke's narrative. Work to incorporate these details into your composition as you imagine what that meeting between angels and shepherds was like for those who were there.



Term 2

Look back at the story in Luke 2 about the angels coming to the shepherds. If you wrote your own poetic/musical retelling of the story, what aspects of the story would you write about in your verses?

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 15

National Anthem (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum part of your anthem from memory?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Listen to the whole song. Then try listening to a line, pausing the video, and echoing it back.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

→ LISTEN (OPTIONAL)

Did you know that the Star Spangled Banner has been the US national anthem for less than a century? Although Francis Scott Key composed the song in 1814, it was not adopted as the national anthem until 1931. Before then, the unofficial anthem was "My Country 'Tis of Thee," which was adapted from the English national anthem, "God Save the Queen." Many other anthems have evolved in a similar way.

∞ Video Link: My Country 'Tis of Thee

★ TEACHER TIP

LITERATURE CONNECTION (Grades 9+)

W.E.B Du Bois (who you might read more about in Literature lessons) wrote a parody of My Country 'Tis of Thee.

• COMPOSITION

Read W.E.B Du Bois's poem and the original lyrics and then write a paragraph explaining how W.E.B. Du Bois's poem critiques the original.

∞ Article Link: My Country 'Tis of Thee by W.E.B. Du Bois

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Video Link: God Save the Queen

WEEK 3 15m Composer Study - Lesson 15

Holberg Suite

→ RECAP

Do you remember any melodies from the Concerto in A minor? Try humming one!

→ INTRO

Grieg produced some of his most famous pieces in the 1880s. Today's piece is a suite (a series of dances) in honor of the playwright Ludvig Holberg, who is considered the father of Norwegian literature (or Danish literature, depending on who you ask). Holberg (1684-1754AD) lived nearly the same time as J.S. Bach (1685-1750), so when Grieg composed a piece honoring the centenary of his death, he sought to create a work that sounded a bit like music from Holberg's time. He composed the piece first for the piano and then added the stringed version a few months later. Read/share a bit more from the article below.

∞ Article Link: Translating the Past to Today

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Today's piece is just the opening prelude to the suite for both piano and strings. You'll find other recordings of the full suite in the playlist to listen to in the afternoons. Keep your notebook out and try to sketch the sound of at least the opening minute or two in your notebook.

∞ Video Link: Holberg Suite (Prelude)

∞ Video Link: Holberg Suite (Prelude-Piano)

• If you wrote a piece of music honoring someone from the past, who would it be?

• Which version of the piece do you prefer?

→ (GRADE 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Continue listening to the next dance in the suite!

∞ Video Link: Holberg Suite (Gavotte)

• EXTRA HELPING

∞ Article Link: About Holberg

• IMPORTANT DATES

Holberg Suite composed (1884AD)

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to the full suite in the afternoons (either the piano or orchestra version).

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 4 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 16

Review Identifying Keys on the Staff

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

∞ Video Link: L2 Lesson 3.10

After listening to the lesson, flip through a hymnal or any other sheet music and practice identifying keys. Figure out the key of at least three pieces.

WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 16

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Sing the song with the accompaniment. Note: the accompaniment plays four verses, so you can stop after verse 3 (we're learning the most famous three verses, but as with many carols, others were penned by various translators and authors over the years).

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Pick a recording below to hear another way an artist has made this carol their own and attempted to convey its message.

∞ Music Links: Celtic Women (YouTube or Spotify)

∞ Music Links: Aretha Franklin (YouTube or Spotify)

• TERMINOLOGY

"Angels We Have Heard on High" is a macaronic song, meaning that it uses two different languages (English and Latin) in the same song. Can you think of any other macaronic songs (older or newer)?

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 16

National Anthem (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of your National Anthem as you can from memory.

→ INTRO

In her book *Ourselves*, Charlotte Mason talks about good and bad ways we can show loyalty to our country. It is a good thing when our love for our country makes us seek to understand its history, laws, institutions, people, strengths, and weaknesses. We should want to love and care for the place we live and the other people who live around us! It is not good when we use our love for our country as an excuse to look down on other people or countries and ignore our own country's weaknesses. On the other hand, it is also unhelpful when we only focus on what is bad about our country. As you sing your national anthem and read the words, think about what kind of love or loyalty the song displays.

→ SING

Try to sing with your recording of choice for the whole song.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

★ TEACHER NOTE

See *Ourselves* p.120-121, for more on loyalty to country, and peruse High School Citizenship selections for additional teacher resources on this topic. You may also wish to preselect and/or preview national anthems for the related composition assignment.

• COMPOSITION

(Grades 7+)

Pick 3-5 national anthems, read their English translations, and discuss the similarities and differences you find. What types of loyalty do you find in each anthem?

∞ National Anthem lyrics



Term 2

→ EXPLORE (CHOOSE AN OPTION BELOW)

- Learn the story of the Star Spangled Banner

∞ Article Link: Star Spangled Story

- Listen to other national anthems in your music playlist with any extra time.

→ DISCUSS (GRADES 7+)

Many national anthems ask a god to protect their country (some mean the Christian God revealed in the Bible, and others refer to gods of other religions). For instance, the Canadian national anthem includes the prayer, "God, keep our land glorious and free," and the British anthem's name is "God Save the Queen (or King)." What do you think about asking God for protection and preservation of a nation or for wisdom for our leaders? If so, is there ever an issue of assuming God is on a particular nation's side? For example, what if two nations are fighting against each other and both are asking God to help them win?

WEEK 4 15m Composer Study - Lesson 16

Holberg Suite cont.

→ RECAP

- What instruments did you see in Holberg's Suite?
- Describe the opening prelude in three words.

→ INTRO

- If you wanted to write a song that reminded you of a particular place, what would you do? Can you think of a song or piece of music that captures the essence of a place somehow?

- As the article from last lesson mentioned, Grieg wanted to create music that sounded Norwegian. In his 20s, Grieg spent a summer with Ole Bull, a famous Norwegian violinist. Bull and other Norwegian musicians inspired Grieg to use Norwegian folk songs and melodies as the inspiration for his music. Some people thought that he wasn't a "serious" composer because of this, but Grieg and many other 19th-century composers who used folk songs in their music disagreed!

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

- Notice that all of the musicians in this performance are playing from memory! Watch how the musicians communicate with each other to draw out the melodies in the piece. Watch and hear the violins talking together as well!
- Listen for big shifts in dynamics (soft, loud, choppy, smooth).

∞ Video Link: Holberg Suite (Air + Rigaudon)
Time Marker: 9:35 - 16:40 (or end if time allows)

- Did you notice that the viola players occasionally use their fingers to play? This is called pizzicato, which is a fun word to say.

→ (GRADE 5+) READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: Romanticism in Music "What is Romanticism" & "Topics of Romanticism"

• EXTRA HELPING

A modern composer reflects on the Holberg Suite.

∞ Video Link: Holberg Reflections

WEEK 5 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 17

Review Singing Different Keys

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.



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→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

∞ Video Link: L2 Lesson 3.11

After listening to the audio, sing the scale in several different keys. Then go back to Step 17a and sing through the first exercise.

∞ Video Link: Step 17a

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WEEK 5 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 17

Angels We Have Heard On High (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Try singing "Angels We Have Heard On High" from memory.

→ SING

Review any places or spots you forgot while trying to sing from memory. Sing the song again with or without the accompaniment and experiment with how you sing it. For instance, perhaps you sing the last verse very loudly since it's as if the shepherds are calling for everyone to come to worship Jesus! Add some notes for yourself in your music journal or lyric PDF on how you want to sing each verse (how loud, fast, what emotions you want to convey, etc.).

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

"Angels from the Realms of Glory" is another carol that reflects on similar themes. Some even think it is an alternate translation of the same original French song that produced "Angels We Have Heard on High."

∞ Video Link: Angels from the Realms of Glory

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 17

National Anthem (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Explain the national anthem you're learning as if talking about it to a friend who has never heard of it.

→ SING

Perform your anthem acapella (just your voice). Note any problem spots and sing it again with the recording as needed.

∞ Music Links: National Anthems

→ EXPLORE (OPTIONAL)

Listen to other national anthems in your music playlist with any extra time.

★ TEACHER NOTE

• MUSICAL CONNECTION

While national anthems became a new genre of folk songs in the 19th century, other musicians composed new kinds of instrumental music that focused on trying to capture the local flavor and culture of their homelands. One example: Edvard Grieg, whom you'll recognize from Composer Study lessons!

WEEK 5 15m Composer Study - Lesson 17

Peer Gynt Suite

→ RECAP

• One author described the Holberg Suite like this: "Originally written for piano, Grieg jazzed it up with strings, giving us five movements that prance around like a Baroque dance party. And the opening 'Praeludium'

• EXTRA HELPING

Short overview of the story of Peer Gynt.

∞ Audio Link: The Story of PG

• TERMINOLOGY

Incidental Music: music composed to go along with a play.



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is like a caffeinated squirrel sprinting through a fjord" (Hermione Lai, Interlude.hk). Do you agree?

- If you had to finish the sentence, "the opening movement is like ____" or "the last movement is like ____" what would you say?

→ INTRO

If Grieg's suite to honor Holberg blended older forms of music with fresh ideas and Norwegian folk songs, his collaboration with a living playwright, Henrik Ibsen, produced a suite which was even more quintessentially Norwegian. Partially because of all the wars and revolutions in the 1800s, many people wanted to create a sense of national pride and identity to show how they were different from other places. In addition to using folk songs and melodies in their music, composers like Grieg did this by creating new musical forms or breaking the rules of older forms.

Peer Gynt is a play written in verse by the Norwegian playwright Henrik Ibsen. It's the story of an anti-hero, Peer Gynt, who makes a series of horrible life choices and eventually is faced with the consequences and has a chance to repent at the end. Grieg's task was to write incidental music to go along with the play - the equivalent of modern-day film scores. He had a horrible time with the project and wrote in a letter:

"With Peer Gynt, things are progressing very slowly, and finishing by Autumn is out of the question. It is a terribly unruly subject, certain places excluded, such as, e.g., where Solveig sings; I have completed all of that, too. And, also, I have made something for In the Hall of the Mountain King, which I literally cannot bear to listen to; that's how much it sounds of cow pats, of Norwegian-Norwegian-ness and self-satisfaction! But I also expect the irony to be felt" (fib.no/en/news/2024/griegs-gynt).

The full set of music for the play was 26 pieces long! But not long after he finished the music, Grieg rearranged several of the pieces from different sections of the play into two suites of four pieces each. These suites are what made Grieg famous, and you may even recognize some of the melodies, as they have remained popular today.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Morning Mood
Time Marker 0:0-4:55

- If you illustrated a picture to go with this piece, what would you draw?
- What instruments do you hear? [Flutes come in first and then oboes and start the main tune].
- Can you hum a piece of the main tune?

→ (GRADE 5+) ILLUSTRATE

Sketch or paint your illustration!

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to the rest of the Peer Gynt Suite No. 1 in the afternoons!

• IMPORTANT DATES

Peer Gynt composed (1875 for the full play and then rearranged and published in 1888 as the Peer Gynt Suite No. 1 and No. 2)

WEEK 6 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 18

Step 18a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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∞ Audio Link: Step 18a
∞ Audio Link: Step 18a Answer Key
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WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 18

O Worship the King

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Angels We Have Heard on High" from memory (if you want to challenge yourself, try singing the verses in reverse order!).

→ READ & LISTEN

We're starting a new song!

- Read the lyrics in your Our Work/Music Booklet or #79 in your hymnal.
- Discuss any unfamiliar words.
- Listen to the hymn (note that V2 has an additional chorus you would want to add to your lyrics).

∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal and/or this short video as time allows.

"Text & Tune" p.182

∞ Video Link: History of O Worship the King

• TERMINOLOGY

- **pavilioned:** enclosed, encircled
- **girded:** dressed

• IMPORTANT DATES

Robert Grant (England/India, 1779-1838 AD)

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 18

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing your National Anthem from memory (or look at the lyrics if needed). Think about the words and try to sing in a way that matches them!

→ INTRO

We're starting our next folk song today! It's important to remember that even while the big, loud anthems dealing with national events and identity were developing, mothers were still singing to their babies (sometimes even in the midst of those wars or other events). Our folk song for the rest of this term is sometimes called Margaret's Song because a girl named Margaret recorded it for the Library of Congress archives. It comes from around the 1830s.

→ STUDY & LISTEN

Read the translation of the song in your Our Work Book/Music PDF and then listen to the lullaby a few times.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa

★ TEACHER NOTE

If your student(s) learned a national anthem not in English during the first part of this term, here is an alternate 19th-century lullaby option in English, if two folk songs not in English are too much of a stretch. There is a beautiful Celtic harp version in the folk song playlist, and a simpler version is linked here.

∞ **Video Link:** All Through the Night (lyrics below the video)

WEEK 6 15m Composer Study - Lesson 18

Death of Ase

→ RECAP

What was the illustration that came to mind when you listened to Morning Mood? In the play, Morning Mood depicts the sun rising over the Moroccan desert, surrounded by palm trees, after his friends left him there. Is that what the piece sounds like to you?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

The next piece in the suite was written to go along with a part of the play

• ILLUSTRATE

As you listen or on your own time, create a series of illustrations to go with each piece of the Peer Gynt Suites!

• EXTRA HELPING

Some think that the sound of Morning Mood is patterned after the tone of the Hardanger fiddle, a unique Norwegian type of violin.



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where Peer Gynt is sitting with his dying mother. Grieg and many composers in the 1800s were particularly good at showing emotion in music. To create a quiet, subdued sound, Grieg wrote this piece for muted strings.

∞ Video Link: Death of Ase

Time Marker: 4:55-10:45

- What emotions does this piece evoke? What features of the music help create this feeling?

→ (GRADE 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Continue listening to the next movement in the suite: Anitra's dance (stop at 14:10). Listen for the pizzicato in this piece as well!

∞ **Article Link:** Hardanger Fiddler

WEEK 7 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 19

Step 18b

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ PRACTICE

First, sight-read the 2/4 exercise. (Hint: It starts on do.) Write note names and the sol-fa. Then clap the rhythm and sing the melody. Next, sing with the answer key. Last, compose and sing your own key of G exercise.

∞ Audio Link: Step 18b Answer Key

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WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 19

O Worship the King (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP & MAPWORK

- What do you remember about our new song?
- Locate Mumbai, India (called Bombay during Sir Robert Grant's time) on your globe/atlas.

→ PRACTICE & SING

- Read the words aloud and work on learning them.
 - Then work on the tune by alternating between listening to a verse and then humming along with the recording.
- ∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

If you could ask Sir Robert Grant a question about one of the lines or images in the hymn, what would it be?

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 19

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Warm up your voice by singing your National Anthem.

★ TEACHER NOTE

Preview the Trail of Tears website for your students before sharing.



Term 2

→ MAPWORK

Our term's lullaby probably originated about the same time as the Trail of Tears, when President Andrew Jackson signed the Indian Removal Act in 1830, forcing many Native Americans (the Creek, Seminole, Muscogee (Creek), Chickasaw, Choctaw, and Cherokee primarily) who lived in the American Southeast to relocate to what is now Oklahoma. (Remember Wallace Willis, who may have authored "Steal Away" from Term 1? He was one of those who had to relocate!). View the Trail of Tears map and read more as desired.

∞ Website Link: Trail of Tears Association

→ LISTEN & SING

Listen once to the song and follow along with the lyrics in your book. Then listen again and try humming along.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

- What do you think makes a good lullaby?

WEEK 7 15m Composer Study - Lesson 19

In the Hall of the Mountain King & Solveig's Sang

→ RECAP

If you had to pick a color to represent Morning Mood and another for the Death of Ase, what would they be?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Today, we're listening to the final piece in the Peer Gynt No. 1 Suite and a particularly famous song from the second suite, which Grieg and his wife Nina used to perform together. Nina was a soprano singer, and Grieg once said that she was the best interpreter of his work.

∞ Video Link: In the Hall of the Mountain King

∞ Video Link: Solveig's Sang

- Guess what Grieg is depicting musically in "In the Hall of the Mountain King"? [Peer Gynt is chased by angry mountain trolls!]
- Describe the mood of Solveig's Sang. [Context to give after initial discussion of the mood: Solveig is the woman who falls in love with Peer Gynt in the play, and she sings this while she waits for him to come back to her from all his wanderings.]

→ (GRADE 7+) READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL)

∞ Article Link: About Nina Grieg

★ TEACHER NOTE

If time is tight, feel free to omit Solveig's Sang in the lesson and assign it for afternoon listening.

• AFTERNOON LISTENING

Listen to the full Peer Gynt Suite No.2 as interested!

• EXTRA HELPING

Recording from 1889 of Nina Grieg singing Solveig's Sang.

∞ Article Link: Nina Sings Solveig's Sang

WEEK 8 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 20

Step 18c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 18c

∞ Audio Link: Step 18c Answer Key

p.20

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 20

O Worship the King (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Can you hum the melody of "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the hymn today.

∞ Music Links: O Worship the King (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

- Sir Robert Grant was inspired by Psalm 104, or perhaps both Psalm 104 and a paraphrase of it from the 16th century by William Kethe (who wrote "All People That On Earth Do Dwell").
- Read Psalm 104:1-4 (or further if you like) and discuss the ways you see Grant working the ideas from the psalm into his poetry. Do you see echoes of any other Bible passages?

• EXTRA HELPING

The image of God riding upon the wind is common in both Scripture and in other hymns. If you learned "God Moves in a Mysterious Way" in Alveary hymn lessons last year, you might remember the line "he plants his footsteps in the sea and rides upon the storm." Look up Psalm 19, Isaiah 19, and Nahum 1 for other Bible passages with this imagery. Why do you think God is described this way?

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 20

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Warm up your voice and then try singing along with the lullaby this week.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

→ EXPLORE (OPTIONAL)

Enjoy this Welsh lullaby often sung around Christmas!

∞ Video Link: All Through the Night

WEEK 8 15m Composer Study - Lesson 20

Children's Songs

→ RECAP

Hum a tune from the Peer Gynt suite.

→ INTRO

Grieg composed a series of songs for children that paint many pictures of everyday Norwegian life. Grieg's and other 19th-century composers' were often interested in using music to express emotion and depict the natural world.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Read more about the songs and pick a few songs to listen to today.

∞ Article Link: Children's Song Description & Translation

∞ Video Link: Seven Children's Songs

- How does Grieg paint a picture with his music?

→ ILLUSTRATE (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Sketch or paint an illustration or two to go with the song(s) you listened to this lesson.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Children's Songs composed (1894)



Term 2

WEEK 9 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 21

Step 19a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 19a

∞ Audio Link: Step 19a Answer Key

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WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 21

O Worship the King (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the connections between Psalm 104 and "O Worship the King"?

→ SING

Sing along with the tune, and then try singing "O Worship the King" acapella (just your voice). Feel free to use lyrics or not, and try to express the meaning of the song as you sing.

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

→ ILLUSTRATE (GRADES 1-6; OPTION 1 GRADES 7+)

Draw or paint an illustration of an image in the song.

→ WRITE (GRADES 7+ OPTION 2)

Compose an additional verse to "O Worship the King" drawn from an idea or image in Psalm 104.

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 21

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, drawing or painting supplies

→ RECAP

Sing as much as you can remember of Margaret's Lullaby without looking at the words.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Sing with the video, pausing after a line to echo it back if needed. Can you sing it by yourself? Try singing along to the instrumental version.

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

∞ Audio Link: Bebi Notsa-Instrumental (Spotify)

→ ILLUSTRATE

Draw or paint an illustration to go with Bebi Notsa.



Term 2

WEEK 9 15m Composer Study - Lesson 21

Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen

→ RECAP

Which of the children's songs by Grieg were your favorite?

→ VIEW

Edvard & Nina's house.

∞ Image Link: Pictures of Trolldhaugen

→ INTRO

As mentioned a few lessons ago, Edvard often composed voice pieces with his wife in mind, but he also composed some pieces for her. He wrote several books of short piano pieces (called lyric pieces), and one is called *Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen*, which he originally wrote in 1896 to commemorate his 25th wedding anniversary. Edvard and Nina knew each other as children and then reconnected as young adults. Initially, both their parents opposed their engagement, but they eventually agreed to the marriage, and Edvard and Nina were married. They supported each other in their musical endeavors and were each other's partners in many ways. But their marriage also suffered after their little daughter died, and at one point, it looked like they might separate for good. With the help of friends, they decided to reconcile; however, it seems they were happy together in their later years at their beloved home, Trolldhaugen.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Enjoy this lively piano piece and explore the recording by Grieg himself if interested.

∞ Video Link: *Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen*

∞ Audio Link: Grieg Plays *Wedding Day* (listen to as much as desired)

• Edvard and Nina Grieg lived just recently enough that we have a few early recordings of their work. Discuss how this changes our ability to understand a composer's life and music to have audio (and now video) recordings of their lives and work.

→ (GRADE 5-8) READ & NARRATE

∞ Article Link: *About Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen*

→ (GRADE 9-12) READ & NARRATE

Start reading the longer bio of the Griegs, mark where you end in your notebook (you'll continue next lessons), and leave a minute or two to narrate.

∞ Article Link: *More about the Griegs*

• IMPORTANT DATES

Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen
composed (1895 AD)

WEEK 10 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 22

Step 19b

📄 Materials: *Fifty Steps in Sight Singing*

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.



Term 2

∞ Audio Link: Step 19b
 ∞ Audio Link: Step 19b Answer Key
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WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 22

O Worship the King (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "O Worship the King" from memory (as able).

→ SING

Look over any tricky places and sing through the song. Then try again without any lyrics (and see if you can see it from memory). Experiment with singing it faster or slower, and think about how you might want to sing each verse and refrain differently to emphasize the meaning. (For instance, you might sing the part about "thunder" very loudly and then get quiet when you sing about "frail children of dust.")

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

→ LISTEN

This is another popular tune for this hymn and also includes a few of the less popular verses. What do you think?

∞ Video Link: Alternate Tune

∞ Audio Link: Alternate Tune (Spotify)

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 22

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Why do you think Bebi Notsa sounds so calming?

→ SING

Use the video if needed to first refresh your memory. Then try to sing the lullaby acapella (using just your voice).

∞ Video Link: Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby)

∞ Audio Link: Bebi Notsa-Instrumental (Spotify)

→ DISCUSS

If you wrote a second verse to the same tune, what would it be about?

WEEK 10 15m Composer Study - Lesson 22

Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen cont.

→ RECAP

Can you hum the main theme of Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen? One aspect of Grieg's brilliance is how many memorable and singable melodies he managed to create.

→ INTRO

View pictures of Edvard and Nina Grieg.

∞ Image Links: Pictures of the Griegs

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Although Grieg did not arrange Wedding Day at Trolldhaugen for orchestra, others have. Listen to the orchestra rendition or a version for saxophone quartet and see which one you prefer out of the three.

∞ Video Link: Wedding Day Orchestra

• **COMPOSITION (Grades 7+)**
 Write a series of similes describing several of Grieg's pieces or movements within pieces that you've heard this year.

Remember this example from earlier in the term describing the Holberg Suite's opening movement "like a caffeinated squirrel sprinting through a fjord" (Hermione Lai, Interlude.hk).



Term 2

∞ Video Link: Wedding Day Saxophone

• Do you prefer the piano rendition or the other one you heard?

→ (GRADE 5+) ILLUSTRATE

Paint or sketch an illustration to go with this piece.

→ (GRADE 9-12) READ & NARRATE

Continue reading the longer bio of the Griegs, mark where you end in your notebook (you'll continue next lessons), and leave a minute or two to narrate.

∞ Article Link: More about the Griegs

WEEK 11 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 23

Step 19c

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 19c

∞ Audio Link: Step 19c Answer Key

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WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 23

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum a tune you know well to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the accompaniment). If you wrote your own verse for "O Worship the King," sing it as well!

∞ Video Link: Angels We Have Heard Tune

∞ Video Link: O Worship the King Tune

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 23

Bebi Notsa (Margaret's Lullaby) (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Sing both of the term's songs. Think about how to illustrate the words with your voice as you sing.

∞ Music Links: Playlist



Term 2

WEEK 11 15m Composer Study - Lesson 23

Fire Salmer/Four Psalms

→ RECAP

What questions would you ask Edvard Grieg if you met him?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Although raised in the Lutheran church, the Griegs, especially Edvard, rejected much of what they were taught while young. However, they continued to wrestle with how to understand the meaning of life and life after death. Some of Grieg's last work, just a year before his death, was a series of four musical Psalms. Enjoy the last in the collection during the lesson and explore others over the week.

∞ Translation Link: In Heaven's Hall

∞ Video Link: Himmelen

→ (GRADE 5+) LISTEN & DISCUSS

Explore the lyrics to the other psalms Grieg composed and listen to the others during the afternoons this week.

∞ Link: All Lyrics

→ (GRADE 9-12) READ & NARRATE

If not done yet, finish reading the longer bio of the Griegs, mark where you end in your notebook (you'll continue next lessons), and leave a minute or two to narrate.

∞ Article Link: More about the Griegs

WEEK 12 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Sol-fa Level 4 Coursework

WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:

Hymns & Spirituals

WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to the course.

Questions will come from:

Folk Songs

WEEK 12 15m Composer Study - Lesson 24

Exams

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 2

Questions will come from:
Composer Study

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 25

Step 20a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 20a

∞ Audio Link: Step 20a Answer Key

p.22

WEEK 1 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 25

Hallelujah! What a Savior

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ INTRO

Have you ever heard the hymn, "It is Well with my Soul"? Philip Bliss was the author of that hymn and our next hymn this year, a popular Easter hymn.

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Read the hymn aloud and then listen to your preferred recording.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Our Hymn, Our Heritage "Text & Tune" p.70

∞ (Optional) Article Link: Additional History

• IMPORTANT DATES

Phillip Bliss (US, 1838-1876 AD)

"Hallelujah! What a Savior"
published (1875 AD)

WEEK 1 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 25

The San Juan Pig

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ INTRO

Our next folk song is about a real event that happened in 1859, which involved a pig eating forbidden potatoes.

→ READ & SING

Read the story in your Our Work/Music book, then listen to the full song.

∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ VIEW

∞ Video Link: About the San Juan Pig

Time Marker: 0:00-2:45

★ TEACHER NOTE

See Extra Helpings for more resources on the Pig War and an alternate recording.

• IMPORTANT DATES

Pig War (1859-1872 AD)

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

WEEK 1 15m Composer Study - Lesson 25

Thomas Wiggins OR Modest Mussorgsky

Materials: Song in a Rainstorm OR Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition

→ INTRO (OPTION 1 & 2)

- We'll get to know a few different musicians this term. Depending on your choice, you'll spend a few lessons with either Thomas Wiggins or Modest Mussorgsky and then finish the term with the work of W.S. Gilbert & Arthur Sullivan.

- Before we dive in, spend a few minutes thinking about what you know that was happening in the 1800s. Think about wars, events, inventions, writers, scientists, and anything else that comes to mind. Then think about what you know about music in the 1800s as well. None of the composers or musicians we'll learn about this term lived in isolation. Their music was composed against the backdrop of slavery and the Civil War in America (Thomas Wiggins), the Russian nationalist movement (Modest Mussorgsky), and a public looking for musical entertainment (Gilbert & Sullivan).

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTION 1: THOMAS WIGGINS)

Song in a Rainstorm p.1-10 "Baby Tom was different" - "continued without them."

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Rainstorm

- Describe or (option for older students) do a comic strip sketch of the story of the storm that you hear in the piece.

→ READ & NARRATE (OPTION 2: MODEST MUSSORGSKY)

Pictures at an Exhibition p.1-8 "St. Petersburg" - "leave me alone."

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

You'll learn more about the backstory of Mussorgsky's work over the next few weeks. All you need to know for now is that we'll be listening to a musical depiction of an art exhibition. Today's piece is the opening theme, which recurs throughout the series of pieces, guiding us through the exhibition. Mussorgsky composed the piece as a piano suite, but a orchestra version by another composer (Maurice Ravel) became even more famous. We'll listen to both today, and you can decide for yourself which you like better.

∞ Video Link: Promenade (Piano)

Time Marker: 0:0-1:47

∞ Video Link: Promenade (Orchestra)

Time Marker: 0:00-2:16

- What do you think this art exhibition will be like?

★ TEACHER NOTE

This will be assigned for older students later in the term but gives helpful context to begin with as well.

∞ Article Link: Confounded Enigma

• IMPORTANT DATES

Thomas Wiggins (US, 1841-1908 AD)

Modest Mussorgsky (Russia, 1839-1881 AD)

• EXTRA HELPING

Listen to a rock version of Pictures at an Exhibition created in 1971.

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Rock)

Time Marker: 0:0-1:57

WEEK 2 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 26

Step 20b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



Term 3

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 20b

∞ Audio Link: Step 20b Answer Key

p.22

WEEK 2 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 26

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Globe/Atlas

→ RECAP

What do you remember about the history of our current hymn and its author?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hooing" for a verse (sing the tune on "hoo") to learn the tune.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

→ PRACTICE

Continue learning the words. Read the whole song aloud. Write down the first line of each verse to help you remember the order, sketch a small illustration for each verse to help you visualize it, and do anything else you like to help yourself learn the words!

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a progression to the ideas in the hymn's verses? Describe how you think each verse builds (or doesn't build) on the previous ones. How would the hymn feel different if you changed the order?

WEEK 2 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 26

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What is our new folk song about?

→ SING & PRACTICE

- Read the lyrics aloud. There are a lot of words, so after reading the full song, reread just the first verse and work on learning it by heart.
 - Listen to the full song. Try to alternate between listening to a verse and then humming the next as you learn the tune.
- ∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ VIEW

Finish the video about the Pig War.

∞ Video Link: About the San Juan Pig

Time Marker: 2:45 - end



Term 3

WEEK 2 15m Composer Study - Lesson 26

Thomas Wiggins OR Modest Mussorgsky

Materials: Song in a Rainstorm OR Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: THOMAS WIGGINS)

What do you remember about our first piece this term?

→ READ & NARRATE

Song in a Rainstorm p.11-20 "Four-year-old Tom" - "professional musician."

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Water in the Moonlight

- How do you hear Thomas Wiggins creating "water in the moonlight" with his piece?

→ (GRADE 5+) DISCUSS

How would you describe the sound of Thomas Wiggins' pieces so far? Compare it with the sound of Grieg's pieces from last term.

PREP: Look over the Promenade Activity below and decide what (if any) aspects to do with your students.

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: MODEST MUSSORGSKY)

Although he was familiar with many European forms of music, Mussorgsky had less musical training than many of his peers. But in some ways, he saw this as a strength because he, like Grieg and other composers in the 1800s, wanted to create a new kind of music. He wanted to create a new Russian sound that was not like the music in Europe. Some philosophers believe that the desire many of us feel today to be unique started in the 1800s, partially because of composers like Mussorgsky or Grieg, and other poets like Wordsworth, or artists like Vincent Van Gogh.

→ READ & NARRATE

Pictures at an Exhibition p.9-18 "For the next few" - "happily behind him."

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

You'll listen to the Promenade again from last week, the first picture of the exhibition (a Gnome), and then a fresh version of the promenade as you move to a new part of the exhibition. If you listen to the orchestra version, watch for another instance of pizzicato!

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Piano)
Time Marker: 0:35-5:08 (Gnome begins at 1:47)
and/or

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Orchestra)
Time Marker: 0:37-5:56 (Gnome begins at 2:16)

- How would you describe the Gnome? What kind of picture do you think the music creates? How?

→ ACTIVITY (OPTIONAL: GRADES 1-4)

∞ PDF Link: Promenade Activity
OR

Unfortunately, the original picture of the gnome on which Mussorgsky based his composition has been lost. Try sketching your own version based on the music.

★ STUDENT/TEACHER NOTE

(For Older Students:

Mussorgsky)

If interested, read/share more context and musical detail from others who have listened to the gnome movement as part of the discussion after listening.

"Although the original Hartmann painting has been lost, it is known to have depicted a grotesque nutcracker with large teeth. It was undoubtedly disturbing. Mussorgsky captured the image in sound using a variety of techniques. "The Gnome" begins with a sequence of abrupt, angular melodic fragments. They are unpredictable and unpleasing, lurching about in a way that mimetically captures the motions of the creature they portray. A second, contrasting section contains an uneven descending melody with a dissonant, oscillating accompaniment. A third section vacillates ominously between low and high pitches, while a final section is loud and threatening. Fragments of the first section interrupt when least expected. Throughout, "The Gnome" is characterized by contrast and surprise, and it concludes with a frightening rush to the final cadence. The listener never knows what is going to happen next and is not allowed to relax."

∞ Reference Link



Term 3

WEEK 3 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 27

Step 20c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 20c

∞ Audio Link: Step 20c Answer Key

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WEEK 3 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 27

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ SING

We'll put the words and tune together today! Listen to the song and pause it after each line to echo it back. Try to think about the meaning of the words as you sing.

∞ Music Links: Hallelujah! What a Savior (YouTube or Spotify)

WEEK 3 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 27

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, US or Canadian atlas

→ MAPWORK & RECAP

Draw a sketch in your notebook of San Juan Island and the debated borders and straits. Refer to your atlas or the linked image and label the key places.

∞ Map Link: San Juan Island map

→ COPY (GRADES 4+)

Write down the first line of each verse to help you remember the flow of the song.

→ SING & PRACTICE

Sing along with the video today. It may be helpful to pause after each line to sing the song back to give equal attention to all the words.

∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

WEEK 3 15m Composer Study - Lesson 27

Thomas Wiggins OR Modest Mussorgsky

Materials: Song in a Rainstorm OR Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition

PREP: For younger students, read and mark sections of the article to share with students curious for more about Thomas Wiggins.

• EXTRA HELPING

(Option 1: Thomas Wiggins)
The famous author of the Nutcracker, Pyotr Tchaikovsky, also composed a well-known "war" piece called the 1812 Overture commemorating Russia's victorious defense



Term 3

∞ Article Link: The Enigma of Blind Tom Wiggins

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: THOMAS WIGGINS)

What do you think will happen next in Song in a Rainstorm?

→ READ & NARRATE

Song in a Rainstorm p.21-end "Billed as 'Blind Tom'" - end.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Battle of Manassas

- How does the piece depict a battle musically? What other ways have you heard music depict a battle, or what other ways would you depict a battle musically?

→ (GRADE 5+) READ & DISCUSS

∞ Article Link: The Enigma of Blind Tom Wiggins

→ RECAP (OPTION 2: MODEST MUSSORGSKY)

Can you hum the opening tune of the promenade?

→ READ & NARRATE

Pictures at an Exhibition p.19-28 "Modest went straight" - "Modest Mussorgsky."

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

- The next part of the exhibition we'll see is an Old Castle. Then we'll walk (to the Promenade again) to another picture depicting children quarrelling after a game! We actually do have a picture of the Castle that inspired Mussorgsky.

∞ Image Link: The Old Castle

- Listen for the promenade so you know when Mussorgsky is done showing you the castle and taking you to the next picture. If you're short on time, you can stop listening when you hear the promenade begin.
- Keep an eye out for more pizzicato and the sound of a saxophone if you're listening to the orchestral version!

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Piano)

Time Marker: 5:08-11:40

and/or

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Orchestra)

Time Marker: 5:56-12:13

against the French in 1812. See the extra helpings link to listen to a recording...with canons!

WEEK 4 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 28

Step 21a

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed. With extra



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time, make up your own exercises using "fa" as the new "do."
 ∞ Audio Link: Step 21a
 p.24

WEEK 4 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 28

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

What is your favorite verse of "Hallelujah! What a Savior"?

→ SING

Hum a hymn from last term to warm up your voice. Then sing with the accompaniment. Note any spots where you need to work more.
 ∞ Music Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

→ DISCUSS & READ

What Bible verses or stories do you hear echoed in the song? Can you find them in the Bible?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Here are a few chapters with relevant verses to read and discuss if needed:

Isaiah 53
 Philippians 12
 John 19
 1 Peter 1

WEEK 4 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 28

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, sketching or painting supplies (optional)

→ RECAP

Tell the story of the San Juan Pig (in your own words).

→ SING

- Can you sing the first verse without looking at the lyrics or listening to the audio?
 - Sing along with the audio today for the rest of the song, pausing to repeat any lines you are still working on.
- ∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time or on your own time, sketch or paint an illustration to go with the song.

● COMPOSITION - Essay (Grades 11-12; Optional Grades 9-10)

Write a research paper on the Pig War. Use the research questions and ideas in the link below to get you started.

∞ **Article Link:** Pig War Research Project

WEEK 4 15m Composer Study - Lesson 28

Thomas Wiggins OR Modest Mussorgsky

Materials: Song in a Rainstorm OR Mussorgsky's Pictures at an Exhibition

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: THOMAS WIGGINS)

Tell the story of Wiggins' Battle of Manassas

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Move as you listen to the music.
 ∞ Video Link: March Timpani

- Does this piece remind you of any other music that you've heard? If you read the description beneath the YouTube video above, you'll see that the piece is designed to honor Thomas Wiggins' teacher. To honor him, Wiggins quotes a famous waltz by another Polish composer, Frederick Chopin.

- Listen to the very first notes of Wiggins' piece again and then the first notes of Chopin's Waltz. Can you hear the similarity?

● AFTERNOON LISTENING

Be sure to listen to your composer study pieces in the afternoons! Especially if you're listening to Pictures at an Exhibition, you'll want to put the piece on at other times so you can listen to the whole thing since we don't have time to listen to every picture during lessons.



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∞ Video Link: Chopin's Waltz

- What do you think our composers, such as Grieg or Thomas Wiggins from this year, would think of the phrase "imitation is the sincerest form of flattery?"

→ (GRADE 5+) READ & DISCUSS

Song in a Rainstorm "Author's Note" (at end of book)

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: MODEST MUSSORGSKY)

- The next part of the exhibition we'll see is a peasant with a cow. Then we'll walk (to the Promenade again) to another picture depicting a sketch of a costume for a ballet of children dressed up as unhatched chicks. If you think that's a funny idea, Mussorgsky thought so too!

- View the sketch and listen for the chirping and clucking of little chicks and lots of musical trills.

∞ Image Link: Unhatched Chicks

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Piano)

Time Marker: 11:40-16:27

and/or

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Orchestra)

Time Marker: 12:13-16:59

→ READ & DISCUSS (GRADES 5+)

Pictures at an Exhibition "Author's Note" (at end of book)

WEEK 5 □ 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 29

Step 21b - Melodic Dictation

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 21b - Melodic Dictation

∞ Image Link: Amazing Grace in G

WEEK 5 □ 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 29

Hallelujah! What a Savior (cont.)

□ Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Recite "Hallelujah! What a Savior" (as able). Remember to pay attention to the punctuation and not just the line breaks when you're saying rather than singing the hymn.

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune



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→ VIEW (GRADES 5+)

Explore the book where our hymn was first published in 1875!
∞ Book Link: Gospel Hymns & Sacred Songs

WEEK 5 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 29

The San Juan Pig (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing as much of the song as you can from memory. Stop when you get to the point where you don't remember the words.

→ SING & PRACTICE

- Pick up from where you started forgetting the words and read aloud or sing the rest of the song, looking at the lyrics (but no audio).
 - Listen to the full song again and follow along in your head. Note down any places where you need to revisit the words or tune.
- ∞ Audio Link: San Juan Pig lyrics & audio

→ DISCUSS

The San Juan Pig is written as a sort of ballad (a story-song). If you wrote a ballad, what event (in the present or past) would you write about?

• EXTRA HELPING

Write your own ballad!

WEEK 5 15m Composer Study - Lesson 29

Thomas Wiggins OR Modest Mussorgsky

→ RECAP (OPTION 1: THOMAS WIGGINS)

What has been your favorite piece from the term so far?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: The Sewing Song

→ (GRADES 7+) EXPLORE

Read one of the newspapers from the time about Thomas Wiggins. Keep in mind that these articles reflect the perspective of the time.
∞ Website Link: Primary Sources

- What do you find more surprising or interesting?

→ INTRO (OPTION 2: MODEST MUSSORGSKY)

We're skipping to the end of the exhibition to one of its most famous parts: "The Great Gate of Kiev" Unfortunately, this gate does not actually exist. Hartmann drew the picture as part of a contest commemorating a failed assassination attempt against Tsar Alexander II. Hartmann won the contest, and the gate was supposed to have been built, but for some reason, it never was.

∞ Image Link: Plan for the City Gate

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Piano)
Time Marker: 28:56-end
and/or

∞ Video Link: Pictures at an Exhibition (Orchestra)
Time Marker: 28:12-end

→ DRAW (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Look at the image of the gate and draw your own sketch of it in your notebook.

• EXTRA HELPING

(Option 2: Modest Mussorgsky)
Some years after Modest Mussorgsky died, 20th-century Russian artist Wassily Kandinsky created an interactive art display based on Mussorgsky's work and Victor Harmann's paintings! See the link in extra helpings.



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WEEK 6 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 30

Step 22a

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 22a

∞ Audio Link: Step 22a Answer Key

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WEEK 6 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 30

When Morning Gilds the Skies

Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Sing "Hallelujah! What a Savior."

→ INTRO

- What was happening in the world during the 1800s? Tell about a few things you have learned in other subjects.
- Our last hymn for the year is from the mid-1800s. Don't forget that people have always sung these hymns in the midst of world events and the joys and struggles of everyday life – which you're learning about in other subjects!

→ SING & PRACTICE

Read the lyrics aloud, discuss unfamiliar words, and then listen to the full song (Note that the first version skips verse 3 in your lyrics, and the second version includes a 5th verse. So decide whether you'd like to learn three or five verses and adjust your lyrics accordingly.)

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify V1, V2)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Learn the history of the song from your hymnal.

"Text & Tune" p.203

• IMPORTANT DATES

"When Morning Gilds the Skies" published (German: 1828 AD, English 1854 AD)

• TERMINOLOGY

-**gild**: to cover with a thin layer of gold

-**canticle**: song

Fun fact: The last quarter or so of the 19th century is sometimes called the "Gilded Age" in US history.

WEEK 6 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 30

Aloha 'Oe

Materials: Like a Bird, Our Work or Music PDF, atlas

→ RECAP

Sing The San Juan Pig to warm up your voice and refresh your memory.

→ INTRO & MAPWORK

- Our last folk song takes us from San Juan Island to Hawaii!
- Locate the Hawaiian islands in your atlas.
- This song of farewell between two lovers was written by the last monarch of Hawaii and is her most famous composition. The story goes

• IMPORTANT DATES

Aloha 'Oe composed (1878AD)



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that the queen and her attendants visited a friend on Oahu. Then, "as they started their return trip to Honolulu on horseback up the steep Pali trail, the queen turned to admire the view of Kaneohe Bay. She witnessed a particularly affectionate farewell between Colonel James Boyd of her party and a lovely young girl from Maunawili. As they rode up the steep cliff and into the swirling winds, she started to hum this melody, weaving words into a romantic song. At the top of the pali, a cloud hung over the mountain peak and slowly floated down Nu'uanu Valley. The queen continued to hum and completed her song as they rode the winding trail down the valley back to Honolulu."

∞ Reference Link

→ READ & LISTEN

• Read the lyrics and translation in your Our Work or Music book and then listen to the full song. Depending on your preference, you can choose to learn the full song or only the first verse and chorus.

∞ Music Links: Aloha 'Oe-Full (YouTube or Spotify)

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (one verse)

∞ Music Link: Aloha 'Oe (one verse with lyrics)

WEEK 6 15m Composer Study - Lesson 30

Gilbert & Sullivan

→ RECAP

Do you recall what music is called when it is written to go along with a play?

→ INTRO

You've heard over the year how composers in the 1800s liked to create large musical spectacles. Our last composer of the year liked to make fun of many aspects of, especially British, society and musical excess. His name was Arthur Sullivan, and he worked closely with an author named W.S. Gilbert to produce a number of funny operettas in England toward the end of the 1800s, about the same time Grieg was composing in Norway, Blind Tom was performing in the US, and Modest Mussorgsky was composing in Russia! Although he is most famous for the operettas, Sullivan did compose several other musical pieces, and one of his very first was incidental music for Shakespeare's *Tempest* when he was only 25.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

This movement of Sullivan's work musically illustrates the beginning of Act IV in *The Tempest*. Listen to the whole suite in the afternoons!

∞ Video Link: *The Tempest*, Dance of the Nymphs

Time Marker: 16:15-20:25

• Describe the mood of this piece.

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Ch.XV p.97-99 "The bandmaster" - "by nature"

• IMPORTANT DATES

Arthur Sullivan (England, 1842-1900 AD)

William Schwenck Gilbert (England, 1836-1911 AD)

The Tempest (1861 AD)

WEEK 7 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 31

Step 22b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups



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→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 22b

∞ Audio Link: Step 22b Answer Key

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WEEK 7 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 31

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF and US Atlas

→ RECAP & INTRO

What does "gild" mean? What is the author describing when he says "when morning gilds the skies"?

→ SING

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Then alternate between listening to a verse and "hooing" a verse to practice the tune.

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify V1)

→ READ & DISCUSS

Read the lyrics aloud and pay close attention to the first line of each verse, as that is the orienting piece of each verse, since they all end with the same refrain.

→ EXPLORE

The first English translations of this hymn are quite long. Read through one or both. Why do you think the four verses we're learning are the most popular? Are there any other verses you particularly like? (Feel free to copy them into your notebook and learn them as well!)

∞ Book Link: Original Lyrics by Caswall

∞ Book Link: Yattendon Hymnal lyrics (Bridges lyrics)

WEEK 7 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 31

Aloha 'Oe (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

What was the story behind our new folk song, Aloha 'Oe?

→ VIEW

This is the view the Queen Lili'uokalani might have seen as she began to weave our song in her head. The second image shows the flower/tree mentioned at the end of the first verse.

∞ Image Link: Nu'uau Pali

∞ Image Link: Metrosideros polymorpha

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

• Listen to the full song and pay close attention to the pronunciation of the words. Make notes as needed to help you remember.

• Listen to the song again and focus on the tune. Start humming along as you pick up the melody.

∞ Music Links: Aloha 'Oe (YouTube or Spotify)

→ EXPLORE

If time allows, learn a bit more about Hawaii's last queen (scroll through the page).

∞ Website Link: About Queen Lili'uokalani



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WEEK 7 15m Composer Study - Lesson 31

H.M.S Pinafore

→ INTRO

One of Gilbert & Sullivan's most famous comic operettas was called H.M.S. Pinafore. Although this sounds like a very official ship name, a "pinafore" is a kitchen apron. And "H.M.S." stands for "Her Majesty's Ship." Does that strike you as a little funny? This is just the beginning of the musical ways Gilbert & Sullivan poke fun at many British traditions.

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Follow along in the Libretto as desired.

∞ PDF Link: HMS Pinafore Libretto

∞ Video Link: Overture & I am the Captain of the Pinafore (next in the playlist)

- What are your first impressions of this operetta? Compare the sound and style to what you remember from Tanti Affetti from Term 1 (look back at the first song in the playlist if you want to refresh your memory!)

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Ch. XV p.99-101 "Once Sullivan" - "every year."

- Did you catch that Sullivan met our friend Edvard Grieg in school? Also, we didn't spend much time with him, but do you remember Tanti Affetti from the very beginning of the year? Rossini, the operetta composer who was writing the birthday song for his dog, is the same composer who wrote Tanti Affetti!

- Discuss the quote: "In music, or anything else, there is a sense in which nobody can teach us anything."

★ TEACHER NOTE

As we get into Gilbert & Sullivan's operettas, be sure to preview any of the full operettas (some listed in Extra Helpings) before watching. Gilbert and Sullivan were men of their time, and some of their plays have problematic staging and thematic content. However, it is important to note and help students recognize the satire that runs throughout their songs, as much of their work did critique British culture and the problems they saw in society around them.

∞ **Article Link:** More on G&S and Satire

• TERMINOLOGY

Overture: opening to a larger musical piece, such as an operetta

• IMPORTANT DATES

H.M.S Pinafore first performed (1878AD)

WEEK 8 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 32

Step 22c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 22c

∞ Audio Link: Step 22c Answer Key p.25

WEEK 8 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 32

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, Bible

→ RECAP

Can you hum the tune of "When Morning Gilds the Skies"?

→ SING

If you feel confident with the melody, sing the full song along with the recording. For any sections that you find difficult, pause your preferred



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recording after a line and echo it back.

∞ Music Links: When Morning Gilds the Skies (YouTube V1, V2, or Spotify V1, V2)

→ DISCUSS

- Read 1 Corinthians 10:31. Perhaps the author thought of this verse when he wrote our hymn.
- If you wrote a new verse or two, what places or times would you include? Think of times when it's easy or hard to do everything to the glory of God. In a way, this hymn is a prayer you can pray as you sing - that in every situation you sing about, you would turn to Jesus and he would be praised.

WEEK 8 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 32

Aloha 'Oe (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you hum or sing the chorus of Aloha 'Oe from memory?

→ SING & PRACTICE

Sing along with your recording of choice, pausing the video to echo back a line as needed.

∞ Music Links: Aloha 'Oe (YouTube or Spotify)

→ EXPLORE

If time allows, learn a bit more about Hawaii's last queen (scroll through the page).

∞ Website Link: About Queen Lili'uokalani

WEEK 8 15m Composer Study - Lesson 32

Modern Major General

→ INTRO

What makes a good army general? More generally, what makes anyone in a position of authority qualified for their job?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

You may want to follow along in the PDF to keep up with the words! This famous song is from another of Gilbert & Sullivan's operettas called "The Pirates of Penzance."

∞ PDF Link: I am the model lyrics

∞ Video Link: I am the very model

- What makes this song silly?
- What do you think Gilbert & Sullivan are making fun of in this song?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Ch.XV p.101-103 "Soon Sullivan" - "very early."

• IMPORTANT DATES

Pirates of Penzance first performed (1879 AD)

WEEK 9 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 33

Step 23a

📄 Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups



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∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 23a

∞ Audio Link: Step 23a Answer Key (Note: Sing the low re at the end of the 4th line.)
p.25

WEEK 9 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 33

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Can you sing the first verse lines of each verse of "When Morning Gilds the Skies"?

→ SING

Sing with the accompaniment (use the words in your PDF or hymnal as needed) and check your work. Go back and listen to the full song if needed.

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune

→ DISCUSS

Do you think there is a pattern to the verses? How would the song change if you rearranged them?

WEEK 9 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 33

Aloha 'Oe (cont.)

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

How much of the song can you sing?

→ SING

Sing along with the recording and note any spots that need more work.

∞ Music Links: Aloha 'Oe (YouTube or Spotify)

→ LISTEN

Queen Lili'uokalani wrote a song that became the national anthem of Hawaii for a time. How is it different from or similar to the anthems you heard last term?

∞ Video Link: He Mele Lāhui Hawai'i

- How would you describe the mood of this song? Why?
- Over the years, people have come to see this song as a symbolic, sad farewell from the queen to her people. How does this fit with the mood you described?

WEEK 9 15m Composer Study - Lesson 33

More Modern Major Generals

→ RECAP

Can you hum a tune by Sullivan yet?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

The Modern Major General is a prime example of Sullivan's genius with rhythm and Gilbert's witty words. The song has inspired composers and songwriters to this day, and references to the lyrics have appeared in Hamilton and Star Wars! One of the most famous parodies is called "The

• EXTRA HELPING

Write your own Modern Major General parody!



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Elements," which you'll hear today.

∞ Video Link: I am the very model

∞ Video Link: The Elements

• If you used this rhythm and melody to write your own song, what would you write about?

→ **READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)**

Explore transcriptions of some interviews with Arthur Sullivan!

∞ Article Link: Interviews with Arthur

WEEK 10 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 34

Step 23b

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ **RECAP**

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ **WARM UP**

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ **LISTEN & PRACTICE**

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

∞ Audio Link: Step 23b

∞ Audio Link: Step 23b Answer Key

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WEEK 10 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 34

When Morning Gilds the Skies (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, painting or sketching supplies

→ **RECAP**

Orally or in writing, describe "When Morning Gilds the Skies" as if talking to a friend who hasn't heard of it.

→ **SING**

Hum a favorite tune to warm up your voice. Sing with the accompaniment recording and then try to sing the hymn without any recording. Can you sing it all from memory?

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune

→ **ILLUSTRATE**

With remaining time or on your own time, paint an illustration to go along with the hymn.

WEEK 10 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 34

Aloha 'Oe (cont.)

Materials: Our Work or Music PDF, painting or sketching supplies (optional)

→ **RECAP**

Do you remember the words to "The San Juan Pig"?

→ **SING**

Sing "Aloha 'Oe" from memory, then listen to the video to check your work.

∞ Music Links: Aloha 'Oe (YouTube or Spotify)

• TERMINOLOGY

macaronic songs: songs (often folk songs) that contain two languages in the same song.



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- If you learned Angels We Have Heard on High in hymn lessons, do you notice any similarities between the two songs? [They both have two languages! The fancy name is that these are both "macaronic" songs.]

→ ILLUSTRATE

With extra time, sketch or paint an illustration to go with this song.

WEEK 10 15m Composer Study - Lesson 34

Tit Willow

→ RECAP

Can you sing any of Modern Major General?

→ INTRO

Today's song is about unrequited love and comes from another famous operetta by our pair. Enjoy this personal recollection about the song from a musical colleague of Gilbert & Sullivan's!

"At a private musical rehearsal of the Mikado at Sir Arthur's house (the principal singers and actors only), I became depressed at the now famous song 'Tit Willow.' I thought, as far as Gilbert was concerned, that the first verse was so much more taking than the last, which was reversing the order of things. When Sullivan played the tune on his piano, it sounded like 'Easy Pianoforte Pieces for Children.'

Seeing my abject look, Sullivan lighted another cigarette and said: 'I see you don't care for it, but it is a question for the general public!'

He was quite right, and I never regret having sung 'Tit Willow,' which I must have done with encores about two thousand times at the Savoy Theatre" (∞ From a Personal Recollection).

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Enjoy the main version of the song and then listen to a version that appeared in pop culture.

∞ Audio Link: Tit Willow

∞ Video Link: Muppet Tit Willow

- What do you think about the idea that performers or authors can sometimes have one opinion about a piece of music (or many different things) that the audience doesn't share?

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Learn more about W.S. Gilbert! There are several resources on this page to explore. The short bio is a good place to begin.

∞ Website Link: About W.S. Gilbert

★ TEACHER NOTE

Today's song is from The Mikado, which is one of Gilbert & Sullivan's most famous operettas. However, even while its authors were still alive, it was temporarily banned for its caricatures of Japanese culture. Read the article below for more on the context of the Mikado and the debate about whether there is any way to leave the problematic elements of the work behind without discontinuing the whole thing. One way to do this might be to focus on performances of individual pieces from the operetta, as we are doing here, rather than full theatre productions.

∞ **Article Link:** Cultural Appropriation & the Mikado

• IMPORTANT DATES

The Mikado first performed (1885 AD)

WEEK 11 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 35

Step 23c

Materials: Fifty Steps in Sight Singing

→ RECAP

Review concepts from the last lesson.

→ WARM UP

Prepare your voice for singing.

∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

∞ Video Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE

Write, sing, or clap back melodies or rhythms as directed.

Music: Level 4

[Click THIS text or scan the QR code for links.](#)



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∞ Audio Link: Step 23c
∞ Audio Link: Step 23c Answer Key
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WEEK 11 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 35

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Hymns, Our Heritage and/or Our Work or Music PDF

→ RECAP

Hum a hymn from last term (or even last year!) to warm up your voice.

→ SING

Sing both of the term's hymns as if you were a soloist (you may choose to sing with or without the piano accompaniment).

∞ Video Link: Hallelujah! What a Savior Tune

∞ Video Link: When Morning Gilds the Skies Tune

WEEK 11 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 35

Term Recap

📄 Materials: Our Work or Music PDF

→ SING

Make sure to stand when you sing and do a few warm-ups to get your voice ready. Sing both folk songs from the term (maybe even try singing one from earlier in the year too!).

→ DISCUSS

Look back at your Our Work/Music book and discuss your favorite folk songs from the year.

WEEK 11 15m Composer Study - Lesson 35

Golden Legend

→ RECAP

Can you hum anything of Tit Willow?

→ LISTEN & DISCUSS

Today's piece is known as one of Sullivan's "serious" works. It is called "The Golden Legend" and is based on a long narrative poem by Henry Wadsworth Longfellow from just a year after The Mikado (where Tit Willow is from) was first performed (1886 AD). It is a dramatic cantata, so it is half a play and half a long vocal work. This beautiful hymn is one of the most famous pieces from it.

∞ Audio Link: O Gladsome Light

→ READ, NARRATE, & DISCUSS (OPTIONAL GRADES 1-4)

Skim as much as you like of the article published in the papers after Sullivan's death. Note especially the interesting disagreement that is recorded at the end of the page.

∞ Article Link: From the Times at Sullivan's Death

- What do you think makes "great" music?

★ TEACHER NOTE

Lyrics:

O gladsome Light
Of the Father immortal,
And of the celestial
Sacred and blessed
Jesus our Saviour!

Now to the sunset
Again hast Thou brought us,
And, seeing the evening
Twilight, we bless Thee,
Praise Thee, adore Thee.

Father Omnipotent!
Son, the Life-giver!
Spirit, the Comforter!
Worthy at all times
Of worship and wonder!

WEEK 12 15m Sol-fa: Level 4 - Lesson 36

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from:
Sol-fa Level 4 Coursework

Term 3

WEEK 12 10m Hymns & Spirituals - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Hymns & Spirituals	
WEEK 12 10m Folk Songs - Lesson 36 Exam Week → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to the course. Questions will come from: Folk Songs	
WEEK 12 15m Composer Study - Lesson 36 Exams → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Composer Study	

Music: Level 4

Examination

Term 1

Hymns & Spirituals

- Sing "Children of the Heavenly Father" and tell what you know about the life and times of Carolina Berg.

Folk Songs

- Tell the names and what you remember about the two folk songs you learned this term. Then pick one and sing it!

Composer Study

- Tell or write about some of the sounds and instruments of the 19th century.

Sol-fa: Level 4

- Sing and record the last exercise completed.
- What is the difference between 3/4 and 4/4 time?

Term 2

Hymns & Spirituals

- Sing "Angels We Have Heard on High" OR Draw or paint a new illustration to go with one of your hymns from this term. Underneath your work, write the line or verse from the hymn that your illustration reflects and write or tell why you chose the passage to illustrate.

Folk Songs

- Sing Bebi Notsa OR your national anthem.

Composer Study

- (GRADE 1-3) Tell all you can about one of the pieces you heard this term. Can you hum a melody from it?
- (GRADE 4-6) Tell what you remember about Edvard Grieg and one of the pieces he wrote. Can you hum a melody from it?
- (GRADE 7-12) Choose one:
 - Write a letter to a friend describing Grieg and his music
 - Write a news article or blog about the composer and his music
 - Create a powerpoint introducing Grieg and his music
 - Create a mood board (digitally or physically) for Grieg's pieces from the term. Feel free to look back at your music notebook for inspiration.

Sol-fa: Level 4

- Sing and record the last exercise completed.
- Write a G scale on the staff. Label each note with its letter name and sol-fa syllable in the key of G.

Term 3

Hymns & Spirituals

- Sing "When Morning Gilds the Skies" and tell which verse is your favorite (or least favorite) and why.

Folk Songs

- Sing Aloha 'Oe OR The San Juan Pig and tell the story behind one of the songs.

Composer Study

- Tell, write, or sketch the story of Blind Tom or Pictures at an Exhibition and hum a tune from one of your favorite pieces this term.
- (GRADE 7-12) Engage with some of Arthur Sullivan's critics by reflecting on what counts as "serious" music. How would you define "serious music"? Is this a helpful category? If so, how? Think about all the music you've listened to over the year (or just the term if you like) and give your own opinion.

Sol-fa: Level 4

- Sing and record the last exercise completed.
- How does the key of F scale differ from the key of C scale?